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Virginia Board of Education, Business Meeting, Thursday, January 28, 2021

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=P6kmxaBMey0
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-24. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:00:28] - All right, just to let everybody know, we're now live on YouTube. I'm gonna go ahead and just share my first screen so that folks that are joining us on YouTube will know that we're gonna get started here in just a couple of minutes.

[00:00:46] - Sorry about my cat. - That's okay. - Hey, Patty.

[00:01:01] - Nice to see you, Susan. - Good to see you. I'm glad I finally get to join like and interact with people on video.

[00:01:12] we are too i'm having a problem sharing my screen let's see leslie would you mind doing me a favor

[00:02:21] um could you try to share your screen and see what you're able to share i'm you know normally um everything kind of pops up to the presentations that i'm able to share but i'm not seeing that option right now and i don't know if it looks like when i pull mine up i have the option to to share anything that's open on my computer okay um well let me yeah i'm pretty sure there

[00:03:00] you do yeah i don't know um not sure i'm only seeing the option to share uh an iphone and ipad online um dr lane i'm gonna make you the host real quick and um i'm gonna sign off and sign

[00:03:21] back on cool i'm here go ahead good morning everyone good morning everybody good morning

[00:03:49] good morning morning morning morning good morning good morning everyone good morning

[00:04:31] yeah i'm i think go ahead and make me host again i think i've i see my normal screen okay you should be host now emily you've become our tech whiz i don't know about that i'd fortunately most of it is uh relatively easy to understand and the rest they have lots of tutorial videos on zoom so that i'm able to figure it out and great colleagues but we've all been learning haven't we that's for sure

[00:05:12] that is for sure and just so folks know we are live on youtube we'll get started here in

[00:05:22] just a minute um all right president gecker it looks like we have all the board members here

[00:06:27] i'm going to go ahead and stop my screen share so everybody thank you can see each other um and we'll get started whenever you're ready call the meeting to order then uh first item is the roll call the members uh dr wilson present dr duran present dr pexton present ms holton present uh ms davis fawkes president dr mann president and i think i'm still here so that's all good

[00:07:01] uh next item is approval the minutes from the november 19 2020 meeting of the board uh has everybody had a chance to read them are there is there a motion to adopt as written or to uh yeah some kind of amendment to them motion to adopt thank you dr duran uh is there a second second okay thank you wilson yes again by roll call dr wilson aye dr duran aye dr pexton

[00:07:34] aye miss holton aye miss davis vaught aye and uh dr mann aye and i vote aye uh good morning welcome to the board of education's virtual meeting our meeting today is being streamed live on the vdoe youtube channel and on the board's public meeting webpage we'd like to welcome those joining us on the live stream from across the commonwealth a couple of things to note about our virtual meeting the board has accepted written public comment for this meeting all comments that were received by 5 pm on tuesday have been uploaded to our meeting webpage and shared with board

[00:08:12] members in time for them to review in advance of today's meeting comments received after 5 pm on Tuesday will be provided to the board in a timely manner. For our YouTube watchers, the chat feature is disabled as it is not monitored by staff. The best way to contact the board is by email at DOE, as in Board of Education, at DOE, as in Department of Education, dot Virginia dot gov.

[00:08:37] Okay, we'll move to the consent agenda. I understand that item D and item E are going to be removed. Is that right, Dr. Mann? Yes. Okay. I couldn't remember the item number. I'm sorry.

[00:08:53] oh that's okay i don't have i'm trying not to do multiple screens and get lost in the media all right uh yes i'm sorry yes you are removing item e did i hear you say yes thank you all right so is there a motion to adopt items a through c of the consent agenda so moved thank you dr wilson is there a second second uh thank you miss davis bought again by roll call

[00:09:24] Dr. Wilson? Aye. Dr. Duran? Aye. Dr. Fexton? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Ms. Davis-Vaught? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. I vote aye. Okay. Item D, Dr. Mann, do you want to address this? Actually, is Ms. Conway on? I'm certainly happy.

[00:09:50] Yeah, Jenna is signing on right now. President Gecker, if you want to do item E first, I think we can get that one handled and then Jenna should be on. She's connecting right now. That's funny. Okay, I

understand for item E that both Dr. Wilson and Dr. Duran are on that list.

[00:10:09] So I'd like first a motion to approve the list with the exception of Dr. Wilson and Dr. Duran, which I guess will be the more challenging vote later on. So is there a motion to approve everybody but Dr. Wilson and Dr. Duran? Make a motion. Thank you, Ms. Davis-Claude. Is there a second?

[00:10:29] Thank you, Dr. Duran. Dr. Wilson? Aye. Dr. Duran? Aye. Dr. Pexton? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Ms. Davis-Vaught? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. Chair votes aye. Okay. And now, is there a motion to approve for the same list, Dr. Wilson and Dr. Duran? Motion. Thank you, Ms. Davis-Vaught. Is there a second? Second. Thank you, Dr. Mann. All right.

[00:11:06] Dr. Pexton? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Ms. Davis-Vaugh? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. And I vote aye. Okay. Now we're back to D. Is Jenna here? Ah, I see Jenna on the screen somewhat. Good morning. Good morning, Ms. Conway. How are you? I am doing well. Thank you, sir. Good morning, Board President. Good morning, Board Members. It's great to be here this morning. Okay. Are you ready for your presentation? Want me to pull up your presentation? That would be wonderful. Thank you, Emily. Okay. Sorry. Is there a presentation?

[00:11:56] i missed the part of that yeah oh yes uh president gecker i think emily is playing up now okay um you know as she uh gets started um wanted to sort of reorient us on what we brought for first review very exciting day in the commonwealth as we are aligning around our a set of birth to five standards or guidelines expectations on what we want for our infants toddlers and preschoolers

[00:12:31] i would like to give you a sense of the process that got us to today and also just take you through how they're organized i know it's a lengthy document that you have received in advance and then just give you very quickly where we go from here as we think about supporting our infant toddler and preschool educators across the commonwealth to use this these are really important as we get closer and closer to the date in which the board and the Department of Education are responsible for the full birth to five sector. So just as a reminder, right, we're still in the process of moving oversight for child care. We've moved oversight for the Head Start collaboration.

[00:13:10] You currently oversee all of the tool-based programming, but having a sort of aligned expectations about what we want for kids is really important and helps make sure that we're using similar language that we can use and support tools from the state that help our educators get better every day at working with kids and supporting kids and families, all towards the goal of kindergarten readiness.

[00:13:35] Emily, if you can take us to the next slide, please. So just as a reminder of the why here, although I know you'll hear later in the meeting about kind of where we are and how our young learners are doing, is that part of our objective and why we wanna speak with a shared language about what we want for infants toddlers and preschoolers is that too many kids um do not have equitable opportunity to come to school ready and as i look at our principals and superintendents and others on the call today um you're recognizing how difficult it is for kids

[00:14:13] how difficult it is for our system if we aren't able to provide kids and families with that opportunity to come to school ready right now the numbers are ticking up even as it relates you know as an impact of COVID, but we know nearly half of our kids are starting school without having the opportunity to develop those key literacy, math, and social-emotional skills. And we look at, similar to

what we see in K-12, and I know you've been tackling as a board, when we look at whether zip code or demographics or background predict that lack of opportunity, they do, right?

[00:14:50] And so really figuring out how we tackle some of the systemic disparities that means that our kids that are black or hispanic who are english language learners who have identified special needs while they're why are they not getting that opportunity to come to school ready next slide please with that challenge in mind um what we are asking you to approve today um is a set of expectations um that will basically help us understand child development and make sure that you know when we're providing the right guidance for infant classrooms for toddler

[00:15:28] classrooms to three and four year old classrooms will help us align create that shared language and make sure that we are providing all of our educators and you remember the diversity of our sector right from small family day homes through to big child care centers and all of this you know and through elementary schools but making sure all of them are able to have tools at their disposal that help them grow and that we align the millions of dollars that we invest in professional development, you know, with what we want for kids. It helps us individualize our care and instruction to meet the needs of infants and toddlers. As you see in the guidelines, we say very different

[00:16:04] things for infants than we do for four-year-olds. This is a period of rapid development and really making sure that we're specific so that we're not expecting two-year-olds to do what four-year-olds can do because that's really developmentally impossible, not to mention developmentally inappropriate. And you'll see that these standards are slightly different from some of the K-12 equivalents. Pull it all in together. We talk about social emotional, we talk about play, we talk about approaches to learning, we talk about the arts, we talk about language. You might say well is that possible for an infant but what we're really trying to do is make sure that our all of our infant and toddler in preschool classrooms are comprehensive. They don't

[00:16:40] have separate subjects but throughout the day through interactions with adults, through play, through a range of activities that recognize the very short attention span of our young learners we're trying to kind of support the holistic development of kids the bullets at the bottom just get how we get here but just a reminder we received federal funding to do this we've been doing this for nearly two years we've involved more than 300 individuals and experts we took kind of the foundation blocks for just for four-year-olds we took what was the using for birth to five we looked at head start and we run this process to kind of get to what we're proposing for you all

[00:17:16] today. Next slide please. This is also important throughout this process where again we sort of involved to kind of we we hired VCU first to bring together higher ed and experts to look at national frameworks and standards to look at at least 16 other state standards but wanted to make sure we had a set of guiding principles that we could all we would sort of make sure that we would honor throughout the process. I think one and we've talked a lot about this as a board is cultural

[00:17:51] responsiveness and really making sure that we weren't privileging Eurocentric or white ways of thinking about what we expect in the classroom or of kids, you know, in our standards. We wanted to be pragmatic. As I said before, we have folks who range from having master's degree and are virtual experts in early childhood through to folks who come into teaching with a high school degree in a family day home or child care center. And so really making sure that we could create a set of standards and expectations that could be used across the board.

[00:18:21] A caveat here, I will say, as you might see in this document, this is a lot to digest. And so when we think about implementation, we have a lot of work to do around really making these usable. We do not expect that you can send a 100-page document to a family day home educator and say, make sense of it. That's not fair. That's not appropriate. We have a multi-month plan. I'm rolling this out to really kind of make sure that we take this big document and distill it down into smaller pieces with supportive professional development. We had a special emphasis on equity and really thinking about how we could design standards to meet the needs of our

[00:18:58] most vulnerable kids. And again, we wanted to make sure that this tracks from birth to five into what we kind of support kids to learn and be able to do in kindergarten. Next slide, please. Sorry, Emily. this then sort of gives you more detail about the structure of the standards as i said before comprehensive so we've got five areas of development play and learning social and emotional development communication language and literacy right again imagine language and literacy looks very different for a six-week-old as compared to a four-year-old physical development and health

[00:19:33] and then in a broad category called cognitive development we cover the areas science people community and culture, mathematics, fine arts. There's a lot of overlap, largely because kids learn through play and largely because the sort of the social emotion development and sort of language and literacy kind of come together, right? When you sort of think about a kid exploring the arts, that's often through kind of, you know, play as well, right? You know, a kid can't learn music on his own or her own, right? That's kind of, you know, also through things like communication.

[00:20:05] kids who do dance that's very physical right where you know and so there's a lot of kind of overlapping you'll see that in the indicators and we also have overlap because of how the way that kids learn and grow um in the age bands as you see in the bottom there from infancy to later preschool there's about a two-month overlap just recognizing that kids develop in a very fluid way and on spectrum at this point in their lives next slide please and and just to to wrap up um i think that kind of to sort of point this in sort of a point of time so we've been doing this for

[00:20:42] the greater part of two years um we've basically involved as i said about 300 plus individuals between the folks that we've contracted between the volunteers who sat on our various subgroups we did two full months of putting posting this publicly and soliciting feedback in partnership with the early childhood foundation we've involved 10 experts from our state institutes of higher education we sort of have 90 reference documents and as i said before 16 other sort of state standards so kind of a pretty comprehensive process that kind of got us to where we are today

[00:21:19] following final approval from you all we will format into a an easier to use and then really start to work with the set of partners around kind of making this usable and accessible for the diverse set of educators that we have so we as i mentioned before we now have all of the quality contractors who support our infant and toddler and preschool educators in child care so we call it the infant toddler support network we'll work with them we'll work with everybody who worked with virginia quality we'll work with head start we'll work with our folks who support vpi and really begin between now and the fall to develop tools some of which are going to be paper documents

[00:21:59] some of which will be training modules some of which will be train the trainer which is basically kind of calling on that whole array of folks who do professional development that's free for child care and for family day homes having them take this and integrate it into their regular sort of training

schedule so you know really making sure that we can do that lots of that work is happening virtually now and so we'll kind of probably take out some of what they're doing now and make sure that we cover this but yeah sort of imagine a full army of folks supporting this implementation we'll also have a communications plan to kind of get folks out um and then

[00:22:36] figuring out sort of as part of our plan tracking the implementation so really looking at you know where this is helpful for folks where there are challenges um you know as we support this use over the course of its first year of implementation next year let me pause there and see uh what questions there are um or if there's any points of discussion well i'd just like to uh president gecker if i may i first i'd like to thank uh miss conway for that very quick thoughtful overview of

[00:23:13] the incredible work that's been happening in this space um you might be wondering why i pulled it off the consent agenda of course i am in 100 support of what is here and i i will say because this of course is a new venture for the board i think it's important that there be an opportunity to really wrap our minds around the work in a substantive way as we're taking on um this body of work and so that was certainly um one dimension i know we have a full agenda i really do appreciate

[00:23:46] the summary but there are I did want to share some of the conversations that I've been having with Ms. Conway and the team. I first want to thank Jenna and Dr. Richardson and Ms. Carol for all of the efforts that have been devoted to shepherd this process as I know we're creating a very valuable resource for the field and it's especially true given a lot of the recent activity that's underway during the brief legislative session that we're encountering right now and the initiatives that have been put forward. I did pose some questions following the first review and I was

[00:24:26] able to get access to some information on those questions earlier this month and Jenna and I have had an opportunity to have discussion, which I really appreciate her engaging in.

[00:24:42] I wanted to just call forward some things I think we're going to have to continue to think about as we embrace this work. My questions really did center on the efforts that are being made to carefully thread the needle regarding how we frame development and learning for these ages, especially for children under the age of three. It is worth noting that the very title of the resource, the document that's been developed is Virginia's Early Learning Development Standards: Birth to Five Guidelines. And I think this was done in my conversations intentionally

[00:25:18] to recognize this important tension that we're balancing. We know that standards within the realm of education reflects a set of expectations about what an individual student should know and be able to do they inform instruction as we expect children to perform and demonstrate achievement based on such standards by including guidelines in the title it underscores the need to appreciate the variability in development especially in the earliest years of a child's life when you take standards language and you apply that to infants and toddlers in a strict manner i would make the case that the very nature of their work is about exploration and discovery

[00:25:58] that creates a foundation, a foundation for knowing and knowing is a byproduct of interactions that requires adults to tune into a child's natural curiosity about everything in their environment. And by giving words to feelings, naming what children are observing, asking questions and so forth, we are ever expanding what they are coming to know. And I think that's a very important emphasis what they are coming to know as i've considered the content in the introduction i believe there are opportunities to strengthen language that reflects this perspective and to

[00:26:35] explicitly note the adverse implications uh for children's development when indicators are used inappropriately as curriculum and i certainly uh hear all of the great work that's on the horizon to develop new tools. But I do think it's important to emphasize this a bit more. I think there are also opportunities to explicitly state the importance of screening and assessment. There's language that makes clear that the document shouldn't be used as a checklist. We don't explicitly speak to actions that educators can take if they suspect a child's development appears

[00:27:14] to be lagging, and we all know there are resources and tools, reliable screening methodologies that can be used to make certain that when a child needs to be evaluated for early intervention services that people are triggered to think about that and not, again, for the very young end of this continuum, believing that I need to be doing something different to make this thing happened that this resource suggests I should be seeing. And I think having traveled the country long before my work here and working with the full continuum of providers that are

[00:27:52] operating in this space, I've seen a lot. I've seen a lot of things get used in ways that unfortunately can set up children for social emotional challenges as a result of not understanding the appropriateness of how we use these guidelines to really focus on interactions and experiences as opposed to teaching two indicators and so I am asking that of course we adopt this these standards as presented with once there's been attention to

[00:28:33] some enhancements that can be made in the introduction regarding these points that I think are really really important for our very youngest learners that I believe just merit a bit more attention so I like to make a motion to that extent and I leave it open for other other questions comments that others may have about about that just so I understand it is the idea that the motion that the document would go forward but there might be changes made between

[00:29:10] now and final publication correct primarily to the introduction to some of the points that i articulated and i did inquire about a couple of the research associated with a few of the indicators in the fine arts area and just having time to to look at that okay uh we have a motion is there a second then we'll have discussion second thank you dr wilson is there any discussion on this. Yeah, Ms. Alton. I'll jump in. Thank you, Dr. Mann, for your careful attention to the work,

[00:29:48] and I think your thoughts will help improve the final product, and I'm supportive of them, both the changes to the introduction and look forward to other suggestions. My question is about process. Can we be specific enough about what the changes are going to be that we can approve them in general terms today and let you and the department work out specific language or is it better i mean we don't want to slow the process down unnecessarily but these are going to hang these standards are going to be in place for a long time to come and if if it makes more sense

[00:30:27] to wait till march to vote on final i'm totally comfortable with doing that too and then you and the department can work and come up with language that we can share with the public so it kind of matters you know how hard is it to get from how much specificity can we do today if we can put it in general terms today then we can approve it subject to the language technical language being worked out but if if it's broader than that then maybe we should wait till march president gecker i have a follow-on question to holton's suggestion because my question was about timing and the

[00:31:05] timeline that is included in the presentation and pushing things out knowing that the idea was to get this in the field i think in march packaging in february um and then so and then implementation full

implementation in the fall so what happens then to that timeline if as miss holton suggests perhaps shifting everything what does that do to the ultimate goal time-wise we asked directly jenna you know when i talked with some of our staff yesterday about this issue they'd indicated that moving to march would not necessarily hurt the timeline uh but what i'm hearing today

[00:31:44] is that may not be 100 right so yeah so i think that my first response to this is is building off ms holton's point which is like we need to get this right right i i do think that based on the communication that dr mann and i have had and that i've shared with dr richardson and miss carroll like i think it is a set of you know very specific language changes that we can make um and that we carry forward that spirit in the array of implementation tools right i mean and again i think it's like i just to sort of emphasize what i've heard from her which is really important is

[00:32:23] like clarifying how these should be used i think really careful attention um to our kind of infant and toddler teachers who tend to be kind of lowest in the sort of the hierarchy and least likely to get the supports and really making sure that we're thoughtful about language and approach and supports right so that these are are used um appropriately more time helps us do it so i think if we're you know if it's possible to kind of approve this month and work with dr man that's ideal just because you know we didn't get more time with with the set of um coaches and folks

[00:33:00] who do the infant toddler training right and and again i also want to note like we've tried to kind of balance in the timing here like you know we want to roll these out because some folks are asking for these we also want to be really careful we have a sector that is dealing with a pandemic right that is waiting for vaccines that has shortages of ppe and so partly why we wanted to kind of have a longer one way of you know march through the fall was so that we could do it in smaller bits pieces here and there rather than trying to like compress it and get it out during the summer where we're likely to see a lot of summer learning happening so my inclination would be if we can figure out how to do it and it works okay with you all to try to get it through but if

[00:33:39] we if it feels like it's too much for that we can make march work too i thought i also understood miss holton's point to be that to the extent it's basically technical edits that's okay to the extent there's going to be any substantive change perhaps the board ought to actually see the final product before it's approved or you know before it comes up for a vote miss holton i don't want to speak for you but i think that's what i heard you say yeah yes and and and here's a here's a thought and maybe um uh ms conway can respond to this but yes the the fundamental thing is these standards are going to be in place for a long time to come and we need to get them right but if we can

[00:34:19] give the department the sense that we are uh in agreement uh in the broader approach being taken uh so that they can proceed to get ready for rollout they can understand that we're not going to come back in march and change something completely uh but that may be still wait till march for uh final language not just so we can see it but so the public can see it so to have us approve yeah i think you're right that technical edits we can we could leave to be

[00:34:52] done but if there's some substance here my suggestion would be that let's let's give the the department encouragement to keep the ball rolling on preparing for rollout, but with the expectation of final language being approved in March. I don't feel strongly about it. I defer to you, those of you who know better, but I just think the sense of it is this is important enough. Let's get it right. And, and, and Dr. Mann's suggestions seem very, very important to, and on point any other discussion. Yeah,

[00:35:30] Mr. Garrett, can I ask a question maybe for Dr. Mann or Ms. Holton, if the changes are actually primarily in the introduction, might you consider approving the standards and we bring the introduction back before everything's published in March?

[00:35:48] I guess, James, it comes back again to what is, you know, what's the necessary timeline? Is there a real urgency here? And this is an area that the board is just getting into, right? None of us have the expertise that dr man has we're all learning uh i shouldn't say none of us i should say i don't have the expertise that dr man has and i'm not aware in the backgrounds of many of our board members that they have the same depth of knowledge that dr man has it might be good for us to be

[00:36:24] approving sort of whole documents instead of pieces of documents unless that you know really upsets a timeline that needs to happen sounds good i'm comfortable either way i was just offering i appreciate that miss conway i mean i i'm still looking to you i'm sorry i know it's weird on the screen you can't see me looking at you but it's uh for a sense of how yeah i can't gauge that what

[00:37:01] the criticality of this you know we don't want a whole process on the other hand there is a lot to be said for the board actually seeing you know in advance what it's approving yeah so here's what i would would suggest um one of the things that that that dr mann and i and have discussed and i think you know this is a really good thing because we both we both care deeply about it um you my emphasis on 300 individuals being involved is less of a number and more around like that you know we have

[00:37:36] 50 states with 50 different sets of early learning development standards right arguably kids aren't that different right like a massachusetts infant versus a virginia infant but what's really important is that these states similar to some of our national organizations that they've done that have had a process by which people are involved and kind of weighed in right and so and and and and that's kind of how you land and that's sort of just it's really sort of symbolically and practically important as we roll this out and say you know this is a these are what we want for our kids right based on on what we know today and to this whole point will be for the next few years

[00:38:11] you hearing this i'm inclined to suggest that we know that we that we do push this back right so there's an opportunity for us to make these changes with dr mann even if they end up only being sort of primarily technical but then we can also i can work with dr dr richardson and miss carol to make sure we then sort of provide you know a chance to be kind of open about them again right go back to some of those folks and i don't think there's going to be an issue but i think it's sort of symbolically important to kind of to be open and transparent about this so we can come back to you in march and say a we've addressed the issue from the kind of our resident like expert member and all of the really important things that dr man addressed and b that i feel

[00:38:50] some comfort on um you know not making a set of changes that sort of veer beyond the technical and we we haven't had our full opportunity to be um you know kind of transparent with our stakeholders so i i would say probably based on what we've heard today and if you're okay with it board and dr mann that we would um make the changes and then bring it back in march i'm totally fine with that and of course i'm i'm willing to work in whatever way is going to be helpful to the department um i certainly in the conversations that we've had and reviewing the information

[00:39:26] i i i feel like the quality of what is there is sound i think the nuances around very young children need to be amplified and i think there's a way we can get there and it's not going to take a pending the incredible work that's been done to bring us to this point um so we can do this i agree i think we can

too absolutely so we have a motion in the second i don't know if uh we're willing to withdraw that i think it was dr wilson miss davis i can't remember actually who made the

[00:40:02] motion in a second i usually do better notes i i believe it was dr man's yes i think and so if dr man were to amend her motion or withdraw her motion i'm sorry yes thank you dr wilson motion withdrawn all right then i think we will move this over to march um this conway of course this doesn't speak at all the quality of the work you and the team have done to date i mean we're all very impressed and happy with the direction this is going and we appreciate honestly your willingness to work further with the board to uh you know push this through in march so thank you

[00:40:42] very much mr gecker yes dr duran a separate question of miss conway if i can sure so miss conway um i loved in the guiding principles that you spoke to the issue and the need around focus on access and equity for many student populations and as i was reading i think last week or a week no two weeks ago the an ed trust report that they had done the first one you're probably aware of it that looked at access and it showed one percent of latino and four percent of black students had access to high quality programs but it listed in there that virginia did not report any data so

[00:41:17] they were excluded from the national study so i was wondering did we not report because we don't have we didn't want to engage and and how can we move forward to make sure that we're capturing that data at a statewide level again the ed trust report november of 2019 i believe is when it was and i just found that interesting that we weren't included in there and they specifically said because we didn't report any so i don't know if it meant we didn't report any to them or we didn't report it at all at the statewide level but i do think that with one of the guiding principles being that's a focus of how these standards will increase high quality programs for our students

[00:41:54] that we need that data point to be able to see where we are now and how we're improving going forward absolutely dr jim we can look into that i know there have been some issues in the past on whether it was you know some of the demographic data and we certainly have that for the school based programs um so we all will look into that thank you but that is that is a concern and i think both thinking about the excess implications and then i think we talked a little bit about this last time but we actually put our standards back out for a month for public comment because we weren't sure that we had fully tested the extent to which we felt like it would be applicable for

[00:42:32] all classrooms all educators and all kids and really um you know to dr man's point earlier these standards are powerful and some of the indicators and examples it gives and sometimes when you look at standards and examples from like a decade ago they seem very white right they sort of the books that they suggest the behaviors that they suggest the music they suggest like doesn't really represent the diversity of our classrooms and so we did do a scrub for that purpose but i would look dr duran and get back to you over email on the ed trust why we weren't able to provide that

[00:43:04] data thank you very much okay i think everybody's comfortable with where we ended up there and we will move on to item f final review of the proposed consolidation of the city of covington and and Allegheny County School Divisions.

[00:43:24] Dr. Sayle, I guess we have some others with us today. - Yes, we do. I am joined by a few others from their joint committee for the school consolidation and I will introduce them. But prior to that, first I just wanna say good morning, President Gecker, Vice President Wilson, Dr. Lane and members of the board.

[00:43:45] It is my pleasure to bring before you for final review the joint proposal for the consolidation of Allegheny County and Covington City School Divisions. As you might recall from our initial presentation in November, this proposal is based on constitutional and statutory authority provided to the Board of Education, which allows the Board to designate school divisions in the Commonwealth in such a way as will best promote the realization of the standards of quality, given certain conditions as enumerated in the Code.

[00:44:15] Additionally, and per 22.1-25 in the Code of Virginia, local school divisions may also submit a proposal for consolidation to the Board of Education for their consideration. In hearing such proposals, the Board shall evaluate the appropriateness of such arrangement and the potential for the promotion of the standards of quality.

[00:44:35] So in alignment with this process, the Allegheny County School Board and Covington City School Board, by way of their Joint Committee on School Consolidation, have submitted this joint proposal requesting that the Board of Education consider their consolidation of their two local school divisions.

[00:44:52] Just a reminder, at the board's November 19th business meeting, members of the joint committee did present their proposal in depth and really highlighted the merits of their consolidation proposal. Notably, the efficient use of existing resources, promotion of student opportunity, as well as maximizing the school board's ability to serve their students and the larger school communities.

[00:45:15] I will note that since their presentation, the Joint Committee has continued to lay the groundwork for consolidation, and I'll note two major updates for you all. So at our request, each of the relevant school boards and localities have amended their resolutions of support for consolidation so that the language reflects that it is the board rather than the department with the authority to decide on consolidation, so really making a technical amendment.

[00:45:40] And the Joint Committee has also coordinated with the General Assembly membership to ensure they have the legislative support they need to execute the consolidation. So Delegates Austin and Senator Deeds have both introduced legislation to update the Charter of Covington to reflect the consolidation contingent on board approval.

[00:45:58] And they have also submitted budget amendments to provide support to the divisions and implementation. So with that, today, the Joint Committee requests that the Board of Education formally dissolve the Allegheny County School Division and Covington City School Division to establish a single consolidated school division.

[00:46:16] I will say that minutes from the Board of Education's December 11th, 1981 business meeting indicate that the last school division consolidation that we've seen, which was actually between Allegheny County and Clifton Forge, was formalized by the board through resolution. So without any other precedent consistent with with what has been done in the past we have provided the board with the draft resolution that would state the board's approval for the dissolution and then of course the consolidation of the two school divisions just a quick note if approved the consolidation would take effect on july 1 2022 with the merger of the student bodies to occur in the 2023-2024 school

[00:46:55] year and i will now hand the stage over to representatives of the joint committee including Mr. Jacob Wright from the Allegheny County School Board Mr. Jonathan Errett from the Covington City School Board and Mr. Steven Peepgrass from Troutman Pepper Hamilton Sanders okay thank you thank you very

much um President Gecker Vice President Wilson Dr. Lane members of the board and Dr. Sale a special appreciation to you for all the assistance you've provided and this is a process that as Dr. Sale referenced hasn't happened since the early 1980s

[00:47:33] um and i think by working together with with you and um and staff and with all of the different folks from all of the the different localities and local government bodies um we've come up with a consolidation plan that really makes sense um in our view and in the view of those who who have looked at it um i'm just going to introduce each of the folks from the localities who are here who will then be available to speak to you as you recall from the last meeting we went into depth as Dr. Sayle referenced on what exactly would be involved in the consolidation.

[00:48:09] So I'm not going to replow that old ground. But as Dr. Sayle said, we've made a lot of progress even since then, including getting the support of the delegation for budget amendments to support this, making those technical changes.

[00:48:24] And just two two nights ago, the request going out from the city for a charter change so that that can then be voted upon, assuming the board approves this consolidation by the general assembly so those who who are here on on behalf of the localities are jacob wright and jonathan errett who are the co-chairs of the joint committee from allegheny county school board and covington city school board respectively we also have sherman callahan with us superintendent of allegheny county schools

[00:48:59] Melinda Snead Johnson, Superintendent of Covington City Schools, John Lanford County Administrator for Allegheny County, and Crystal Oneidas, City Manager for the City of Covington. So a broad range of leaders from each of the different localities involved and they have been phenomenal to work with and have really dug in and in putting together a proposal that they believe will best serve the students and families of the populations they represent um so with that to the extent the board has questions i'll let the the real experts who are all the local

[00:49:39] participants who are here answer those but i'm always of course available to address legal questions um as dr sale mentioned um i understand that draft resolution is before the board i took a look at it as well um it all looks accurate reflects the the proper dates that different different steps were taken um and uh and certainly makes sense from from our perspective so thank you okay well thank you uh first to the board are there any questions at this time i have one of

[00:50:12] dr sale um so would the board need to approve the resolution and and then a separate vote on on the um final action for the uh consolidation or is the other the vote considered one vote considered for both and i i may actually defer to to our legal folks on the call but my understanding as the resolution reflects both the dissolution and the consolidation so it would be a single vote on the the draft resolution that's correct dr sale thank you susan okay uh any other questions

[00:50:48] mr gecker not a question but just a comment very very briefly reiterating i we've said it before but i'm just so impressed at the public servants and you know local school board local uh uh government is hard hard tough work and you all made some very tough important decisions here to benefit your your community and i commend you all mr wright mr eret and all your colleagues great work anybody very much i've got just one question

[00:51:25] i guess and i'm not sure who's the right person to answer it uh last time we talked i asked if you would go forward with the consolidation if the assembly didn't provide the funds that you were looking for

and the answer was basically no uh my understanding is the assembly is still in session the budget's not decided. If we consolidate, you know, it takes a lot to divide it again.

[00:51:49] And I certainly don't want to do something today that, you know, we're going to have to then play with undoing it if the assembly doesn't fund you the way you think they're going to. So let me ask again, if we do this today and the assembly doesn't fund, are you all still going forward?

[00:52:10] president gecker this is crystal nidus with the city of covington um if i may answer that i think it goes a little bit of both ways we have sort of a dual phased approach to our consolidation plan here part one calls for consolidation of administration and then the second part that would be combining of the actual student bodies in the curriculums and all the extracurricular scholastic activities there from our understanding and what we would still plan on doing regardless

[00:52:47] would be working in earnest to still combine our administrations and then still continue to find ways to eventually get to combining the student bodies as we recognize the need for opportunities for students as well as the need for putting our limited local dollars to best use for our localities as well as our school systems does that answer your question sir uh i'm not sure actually

[00:53:24] so we have a phased approach so you know the first part would be combining administrations so that's something that we're prepared to go forward with with or without state funding the second part where we're combining all of our student bodies and all of our teachers into sort of a holistic system that's where the funding gets a little tricky and we recognize that we have to be committed to the process because of the need for opportunities for students as well as the need to make sure that we're making the most of our limited dollars here so we may not get there in

[00:54:04] in the same time frame if we don't get the state funding, but our plan is to still work to get there. Okay, so regardless what you're saying is that the admins will be combined and it will be a single school system from the administrative perspective. I think you're on mute still. I'm so sorry I'm muted. And I don't want to speak for our school board members, but that is our intent from the local government perspective of realizing the need for stronger fiscal management, but I will defer to the chairs of the committee as well if they would like to expand on that.

[00:54:43] Sure and thank you for your question President Gecker and Ms. Onitas I think is correct. I think your previous panelist may have illustrated it at least in my mind a little better is there would be a phased approach and a lengthening of the runway so to speak. The proper considerations from the General Assembly would be necessary for us to implement everything that we've proposed, specifically the equalization of salaries and benefits among the staff of the two divisions.

[00:55:15] And in absence of the right level of support to do that in the timetable that we've proposed, we wouldn't necessarily just have to lengthen that runway a touch and take a more phased approach, as Mr. Knight has alluded to. When you say lengthen the runway, do you mean defer the time when you actually combine the administrations and systems, or do you mean, is that what you mean?

[00:55:39] The consensus from our local group is that the combining of the central administration, the combining of the two divisions could happen on schedule. Of course, the expensive work that we will have to do at some point is that salary and benefit equalization among our staff.

[00:55:57] So that would take some very careful consideration from our local folks, obviously, as to how quickly we could do that if we had to go forth in absence of the level of state support that we believe we

need.

[00:56:13] That being said, as we've alluded to, we have had good communication with our state delegation, and we're cautiously optimistic, I believe, that they would have our best interests in mind as we go forward.

[00:56:34] So you would, after consolidation, you would only have one superintendent? Yes, sir. Anybody else have any questions? And thank you for the answers, by the way. Honestly, I'm still a little bit concerned that I don't hear the, you know, sort of, yeah, we're going to do this regardless answer.

[00:57:00] We're going to do this. I appreciate that. Just because, like I said, to undo this is not so easy. President Hecker? Yes. Could I please ask everyone to go through this one more time because I missed some of that.

[00:57:18] We're going to make it happen. We just have to figure out how to make it happen. exactly we're talking about a phased approach um you know we really need the help from the general assembly to be able to equalize salaries um and to implement an early retirement incentive program like we've discussed in our proposal um but we're we're going to we're going to make it happen and if i may since i've been working with our trump and strategies group um in deal in

[00:57:55] talking with um the legislature about this i think they are watching this proceeding very carefully um and when you know approval by the board is something that they are going to be looking at as they make their decision about how much ultimately to appropriate in that budget so there is somewhat of a chicken and egg issue going on here as well um but uh you know i think the fact that we've got that um the money in the budget that's been proposed um is uh speaks to their level of commitment to this and and senator deeds and um delegate austin are are very very

[00:58:33] supportive and um i think many folks from all around the commonwealth are looking at this as a you know especially for rural districts a a a pathway that others might want to take and so i think we're seeing at least from what i can tell support on the budget side from the general assembly as a result as a result of that i mean y'all should not uh take this question you know these questions the wrong way you know i'm very supportive of the idea of consolidation what i don't want to do is come back next month and say well we didn't get the money

[00:59:08] so now we've got to divide so am i understanding that um without funding that the two divisions are going to go ahead with consolidation administratively aligning salaries but um the phasing in of the students the academics and and all of the support is going to come later but the the students will remain in their separate buildings is that correct yes yes ma'am miss davis fought um the i guess the

[00:59:45] question as it's been asked is is what would we do if we got you know less than ideal um assistance from the general assembly and obviously we would need to see just how far that fell short uh as to to what our capabilities would be uh we know what the numbers are we know how much we need to equalize salaries and benefits on year one and that's our goal um and then we also know uh what we've what we'll need to fund an early retirement incentive program because obviously one of the things the new division will will have to do is right size from a staffing standpoint and we've

[01:00:20] chosen to implement an early retirement incentive program and hopefully a well-funded one that will provide a win-win benefit both for the division and then also for the employees who are in that phase of their career so I think that's where if we're going to talk specifics the first part of that if funding

were to fall short than what we've requested we would necessarily have to dial back certain portions of that obviously the early retirement incentive program would be among the

[01:00:54] first to be considered and that would impact our future ability or how quickly we would be able to right-size the division from a staffing standpoint so that's why I think I apologize for some of the more vague answers before but our local folks have been working very hard trying to go through some of the potential scenarios and but yes ma'am you're correct the the central office merger and the combining of the two divisions should be able to go forward even if we had a substantial decrease in in the funding that we've asked from the general assembly thank you very much

[01:01:34] sir anybody else so president gecker i just have a couple of comments sure dr wilson thank you um i want to just first acknowledge as miss holton did the hard work that it takes to have begin a conversation like this and then to see it to this point having served as a school superintendent myself i want to say to the superintendents here i understand what you all are also doing to ensure that your local school communities alongside your school board members are moving in the same

[01:02:11] direction as this proposal suggests so i want to acknowledge that i also want to acknowledge that the commitment that i hear uh for providing that the rationale that perhaps the core rationale of why this is coming forward is to ensure quality continued opportunities for the students and so you may recall when we met in november that was a question that i had again i've served as a superintendent so i understand also how sometimes business becomes part of the conversation

[01:02:48] and we know that that is a reality but i will implore encourage and trust that as this moves forward either now in phases wholesale that the best interest of the students in your school division the one or perhaps the two for a little bit longer whatever it happens to be that that remains why you are moving forward with this and so certainly as a board that is our concern for equitable opportunities student achievement and ensuring that students when they leave us are

[01:03:24] ready to meet their future not our past and so thank you all for the hard work that you all are doing in this way thank you dr miss thank you very much anybody else on the board i don't see anybody and so uh is there yeah i will of course echo what miss holton and dr wilson just said you know i was a board of supervisors member uh in chesterfield i can't imagine how you guys did this honestly locally we never could have done something like this the discussion would have

[01:04:03] been so polarizing that uh you know it wouldn't have gotten out of the gate so it's very impressive what you've done and we wish you the best of luck uh i'll be happy to entertain a motion to adopt the resolution uh combining the two school divisions yes okay uh again we're doing all this by roll call dr wilson aye dr duran aye dr pexton hi miss holton hi miss davis vaughts

[01:04:41] aye dr man aye and i vote aye yes i was it what the board has brought together let no man cast the sundry whether it's the appropriate thing here congratulations thank you all very much thank you thank you very much thank you board i appreciate that okay feel like we've been to a wedding so now we move on to item g uh first review of proposed revisions to the guidelines for uniform performance standards and evaluation criteria for teachers ms pitts thank you good

[01:05:21] morning president gecker members of the board and dr lane it certainly is my pleasure today to present to you the first review the proposed revisions to the guidelines for uniform performance standards and evaluation criteria for teachers in our discussion today i will refer to the document

primarily as the guidelines i have a few preliminary introductions acknowledgements and comments before we begin the powerpoint presentation today first i'm pleased to introduce to you two individuals who work with the department of education on this initiative i really appreciate

[01:05:58] the collaboration that we had with them and i thank them for for their work first my co-presenter today dr james strong dr strong is the president of strong and associates educational consulting he is also the heritage professor in the education policy planning and leadership area at the college of william and mary also join up joining us today is dr jenny conison she is the vice president of strong and associates i also wish to acknowledge and thank the work group members whose names are

[01:06:34] listed on pages 90 through 92 of attachment a to the board item this was an outstanding group in the department appreciates the work of those members. As you know, the Board of Education is required to establish performance standards and evaluation criteria for teachers, principals, and superintendents to serve as guidelines for school divisions to use in implementing educator evaluation systems. The Code of Virginia requires that teacher evaluations must be consistent with

[01:07:11] the performance objectives or as we refer to them in the guidelines as standards set forth by the board and that the school procedures for evaluating instructional personnel address student progress the current guidelines originally were approved in 2011 and dr strong worked with us on the development of those guidelines and subsequently they were revised in 2015 and in 2020 to address the weighting of the performance standards. Emily, will you go to the

[01:07:50] next slide, please? As you can see, the work to revise the guidelines for uniform performance standards and evaluation for teachers, principals, and superintendents was planned as a three-phase process. Today we're looking at the guidelines for teachers. In phase one the board revised the guidelines to address the weighting of the standards specifically standard seven student

[01:08:24] academic progress. Now in the proposal it's now standard eight but it was standard seven when we did this work. As approved by the board of education how student academic progress is met is the responsibility of local school boards provided that standard seven student academic progress is not the least weighted of the performance standards or less than one or ten percent however it may be weighted equally as one of the multiple lowest weighted standards that work

[01:08:59] was completed and those revisions became effective January 2020 so approximately one year ago now we are in phase two. In phase two we convened a work group to review the current guidelines for uniform performance standards and evaluation criteria for teachers and the purpose of this phase is to update the current guidelines to address culturally responsive teaching and equitable

[01:09:34] practices, review the research and update it, as noted in the document, and make technical edits to the document. As shown in the proposed guidelines, the primary revisions presented today are to add a performance standard in culturally responsive teaching and equitable practices and to change the terms for the rating levels for summative evaluations. During During the review process by the workgroup, the members recommended language changes to

[01:10:10] provide additional clarity and clarification, as well as some suggested formatting revisions, moving the text in the document, you'll see some areas that have been stricken and rewritten, but in some cases they're moved for ease of use.

[01:10:28] In phase two, we will continue this work to align the guidelines for principals and superintendents as they need to be aligned with the guidelines for teachers. Now, moving on to phase three, third part of this work, the Department of Education will issue a request for proposals to develop an entirely new statewide evaluation system for teachers, principals, and superintendents.

[01:10:59] And the slide before you shows the timeline proposed for this work. In the spring 2021, we will solicit input from you, the board, on the criteria for the request for proposals.

[01:11:18] In the summer and the fall of 2020, we will issue a request for proposals as well as issue a contract. In the spring 2020, this work will begin and we will develop new performance standards and evaluation criteria.

[01:11:38] In the spring of 2023, will present the proposal to the Board of Education, and in 2023 and 2024, we will provide statewide training which will be critical to the success of the new system. And by July of 2024, the new statewide performance standards and evaluation criteria will be implemented.

[01:12:08] At this time, I'd like to turn the presentation over to Dr. Strong to review phase two of the work that has completed the guidelines for teachers we will bring back to you at a later date the work for on the performance standards and evaluation criteria for principals and superintendents so dr strong and emily you can advance the slide thank you thank you miss

[01:12:42] pitts good morning president gecker vice president wilson board members superintendent lane and other colleagues. It's a pleasure to be with you this morning. I think we have about 11 slides to highlight the revisions that have been made in the current performance standards and evaluation criteria for teachers. So let's talk about the standards and evaluation. First two slides highlight the inclusive nature of the review, design, and development of the updated guidelines

[01:13:22] that we're bringing to you this morning. These included a number of practitioners representing a variety of organizations. Among the participants, there were six teachers, one media specialist, one counselor, so eight teacher instructional practitioners. And I think it's really important for me, as someone who works with evaluation in a lot of states and countries, to always remember the purpose of standards and guidelines and evaluation practices like we're presenting

[01:13:57] is for improvement of teaching. When teachers get better, students get better. That's our only way of affecting the future of our young people across the Commonwealth of Virginia. These standards in when they were initiated, actually an earlier version in the year 2000 and then 2012 and the subsequent changes that have been made, in my view, always have had as the single focus teacher support and improvement. There are requirements in state statute for accountability, and of course

[01:14:35] those are embedded in the design that you have in front of you. But ultimately, everything that we've done and what all of these workgroup members focused on was improvement for and support for our teachers across the commonwealth and what i guess now will be 131 school divisions following what we just heard from allegheny and covington emily can we go to the next slide please multiple

[01:15:08] organizations were represented and given ample opportunity to address any revisions that were made in fact one of the documents board that you received is a marked up copy that is pretty horrendous to review because it has so many revisions. That reflects four iterations of the review with the work group and some of those changes that you're seeing are paragraphs that have been highlighted when in essence there was only a sentence perhaps that was changed in those.

[01:15:44] So we focused in this work on what we need to do to update. How do we make this current as current as possible with where we are with the latest research and going forward and with a particular focus on building a new standard which brings the total standards from seven to eight emily next slide please and this is progressive disclosure on this slide in preparation we

[01:16:21] conducted through the Department of Education a statewide survey in September and October to ask the school divisions with each division reporting once how they were currently using the state teacher performance standards and evaluation system. 70 school divisions responded and of those approximately 54% indicated they used the guidelines as is with no modifications. In essence, if we take those 70 to be representative of the full set of school divisions, a little

[01:17:01] more than half of the divisions use the exact guidelines and the evaluation handbook and materials that we developed previously and that are promulgated by the Department of Education. the remaining school divisions made modifications almost always minor modifications for for a local purpose the survey had a number of specific questions about desired changes to the current system and we use this information to guide the work with the work group next slide please emily

[01:17:39] here are just very quickly some key findings from the statewide survey the leas repeatedly asked uh if they can what they can modify in terms of the guidelines there are certain aspects of the the standards that they would be unable to modify but what can they modify they wanted clarity on this issue and while we've addressed this previously in the new version the clean

[01:18:15] version that you have in front of you we tried to be explicit in terms of what leas have the prerogative to amend to revise as they implement in their local school divisions we also learned from when we asked questions about what data sources are used in evaluation 100 of the participating school divisions indicated they use formal observation and almost 100 use informal observations. This means supervisors, principals walking into classrooms, or more recently,

[01:18:52] virtually walking into classrooms, observing what's occurring with students and with teaching. 61% of the participants use student surveys. 19% use them only with some of their students and not all of their students. Artifacts of performance are used in about a quarter of the school divisions and a little more than half use self-evaluation. So that's just sort of a lay of the land of the actual practices that are occurring across our school divisions in Virginia. Almost all of

[01:19:31] them use both quantitative and qualitative measures of student growth, which they were allowed to do. A significant training was provided in 2012 on this issue, and they've continued those practices. So with our next slide, to finalize a few points about the survey, we provided, we developed a teacher performance evaluation system handbook, and most of the school divisions use that. They take it as is, or we even indicate what modifications they can make, provide it as a

[01:20:10] document and then the local school division adopts that for their local practices. The school divisions indicated they would value our adding to a new version. The version is before you and it will be continued with additional work. Content-specific appendices such as do math teachers have specific indicators of performance that would vary from biology or that would vary from early childhood. So we intend to add appendices that will address any uniqueness

[01:20:47] among the various teaching positions that are available. They very clearly indicated they would strongly prefer to have additional training provided so that they could roll this out in their school divisions

with fidelity and with ease. Many divisions also indicated they would value having at some point and a parallel system for what we might call educational specialists, which would be library media specialists, school counselors, and others. Okay, next slide, please,

[01:21:25] Emily. So for the work group, without spending a great deal of time on each of these points, the key item I'd like to highlight is that we did a lot of homework. We prepared the research base. We updated what is known about student growth measures and how they can be used, the advantages and disadvantages of doing so. What is the latest empirical research base around uniform performance standards? What do we know from our work in other states and field

[01:22:02] testing and from empirical studies? We provided fact sheets. We provided everything that we could in preparation to make the job of the work group more aligned with best practice and with the latest research-based guidance that we have. We drafted changes to the guidelines based on the survey results, based on the research, based on field testing and lessons learned with other states, and with that we proceeded with virtual work group meetings in both in November and in December with

[01:22:40] considerable work occurring between those meetings and even following that. Emily? So here are the changes that you have before you. One, I've already highlighted the fact that there were four iterations that we used in getting to where we are. We added two new sections, a section on growth and improvement to highlight some of the words that I mentioned at the very beginning, that evaluation

[01:23:15] is about teacher success. It's about growth, professional development. We also added a section on what can school divisions modify. So it's explicit in terms of the guidelines where they can make changes in their districts across the big state in which we live. And then we revised a section on connecting teacher performance to student academic progress. This is a requirement in the Virginia Code. We remained faithful to what the requirements were, but quite honestly,

[01:23:50] we toned down some of the language from the 2012 version, and we were consistent with what you adopted in January of last year in terms of equalizing the weighting that goes into the standards, including student academic progress. Next slide, please, Emily. We also made changes to existing standards, indicators, and rubrics, those were minor changes. We simply updated the wording. It's essentially wordsmithing. What is the best language for clarity in terms of what

[01:24:28] was needed? And then the biggest change that was made in the draft recommendation before you is an eighth standard, culturally responsive teaching and equitable practices. This meant developing a description for the standard, creating agreeable research-based performance indicators, performance providing a four-point scale performance rubric, suggesting artifacts that teachers could present to demonstrate they're meeting this standard, and then providing

[01:25:04] sample student survey questions that would be included in surveys that are provided as an option by school divisions. And those surveys are designed at readability levels and wording levels at four different levels, a primary, intermediate, middle school, and high school level.

[01:25:22] So that is, and Emily, if we could continue, that was the biggest assignment for the work group. Here is the actual new performance standard. You have it in the guidelines, in the materials that you've received, but we wanted just to highlight and put it in front of you. The way the system operates is that each school division would be required to implement the standard. We made it standard six and we reordered some of the other standards. Underneath it there are seven what

[01:25:59] might be called in a colloquial fashion look-fors. This indicates what someone would see, hear, experience in visiting a classroom, reviewing artifacts, seeing the work that teachers do with colleagues, with parents, with students, that reflect the good work that's designed into the definition of this standard. So, these would be the look-fors for evaluators and also highlight the work that teachers themselves can and should be aware of as part of their role and responsibility.

[01:26:38] Next slide, please. Continuing with the changes, we added wording to emphasize how important it is to use multiple data sources. If there's anything that we know from quality performance evaluation that improves teacher performance and student learning, it's that we must use multiple data sources. We cannot rely only on, for example, classroom observation. We really need to use other sources, and we spend significant time and effort to update and design these multiple data

[01:27:17] sources we change the wording for four levels of summative evaluation state code requires that there be a summative evaluation the four pre levels in the current system are in front of you exemplary proficient developing needs improvement and unacceptable what has come to be much more standard practice in other states since we developed this in 2012 2011 2012 is the use of of more behavioral terms. Highly effective, effective, approaching effective is the term

[01:27:55] that the work group preferred for the third level and ineffective. So behavioral terms as opposed to ones that previously had a little more subjective flavor to them. And then we modified forms that were required by the other changes that occurred. And we clarified the requirement from the code and the Virginia Department of Education to have a single summative rating. We provided an example and scoring ranges so school administrators will know precisely how to implement with fidelity

[01:28:31] when it gets in their hands. Next slide, please, Emily. And this is, I believe, our final slide. The proposed timeline we have is for following this review with you to have a final board review.

[01:28:54] And if you desire to approve it at your March meeting, we will proceed with creating all of the subsequent documents that will support the official uniform guidelines. For example, in March and April, we will develop an updated teacher performance evaluation system handbook that can go to school divisions to use exactly as it is to alleviate a lot of the work, most of the work.

[01:29:24] And in many instances, all of the work that school divisions would have to design and move forward with implementation. In April, we would convene work groups for the handbook and add to the handbook, not the guidelines, but to the handbook, any unique indicators of performance for chemistry, kindergarten, math, and everything in between.

[01:29:52] Also in April, I'm sorry, I misspoke. In April, that would be the work on the handbook. We would have the subject matter expert group doing what I just described. April and May, building off of this in a linear fashion, we would create training materials, develop those working closely with the Department of Ed, and with the intention of delivering regional training on the updated system with four full-day regional training sessions.

[01:30:22] At this point, we don't know if those would be in person or virtual, but we do plan for four full sessions to accommodate as many participants as possible, including teacher representatives from school divisions that choose to invite them.

[01:30:40] To be determined are dates beyond the summer for principal and superintendent evaluation update, additional training, and full rollout for the current system before, and actually some of it

concurrent with, the rollout for phase three that Patty described at the very beginning of the presentation. So with that, difficult for me as a professor not to say more. I tried to be as succinct as possible it may not feel like it or sound like it but i did let's go to questions if

[01:31:13] we may and we're open to uh to your questions uh board members okay are there any questions mr gecker president gecker yes dr garan um thank you dr strong for your um work on this i really appreciated the change in the ratings to be more behavioral focused i think that will be very helpful for administrators and for teachers or staff who are receiving their evaluation to frame it in the sense of their behavior and their actions taken towards improvement on the

[01:31:48] standards as opposed to the other more adjective, if you will, that was given prior. So thank you for that. Question and a comment kind of connected on the new performance standard, I guess that was slide 10 maybe, where we list the seven different indicators to look for. I'm concerned that maybe in one of them, maybe 6.1 or somewhere, we don't relate it or aren't as articulate to what we're going to see in a later presentation from, I think, Leah Walker about our definition of education equity, which I think expands a little bit to think about our students'

[01:32:26] abilities, students with disabilities, languages spoken, race, gender, zip code, socioeconomic status. So I'm just wondering if you can share with me your thoughts and the workgroup's thoughts, And Leah, welcome yours if you have any also on this about how we can be clearer and more articulate in making sure we're aligning the work that we're asking our staff to do to what we're looking at in terms of overall equity.

[01:32:51] I find sometimes in working with teachers or even my own journey working in this area that we tend to focus on aspects about equitable practices that we are comfortable with or that we feel are areas of passion of ours.

[01:33:06] But at times, we don't remember or forget other groups of students that really need to be part of that. So I love item P that's coming up. I know on slide two there, Leah and her team are going to talk to us around the education equity in Virginia and our definition there. And for me, it seems there's a little bit of a mismatch or not clarity in the standards.

[01:33:27] That's what we're seeking on performance six, performance standard six. This is Patty. I'll begin. Leah Walker was on our group and she was very helpful in the development of this standard. Certainly we can go back and refine and change the standard to reflect your comments that you just made. Leah, would you like to make any comments in that regard?

[01:34:02] Yes, thank you. Good morning members of the board and Dr. Duran, thank you for your question. I think, you know, as we were working with the broader education stakeholder community that was involved with helping to develop the standards, there was a lot of education that really needed to happen in terms of bringing them to a shared understanding of what education equity means and looks like and what a culturally competent vision of education in the commonwealth means, right?

[01:34:33] And so I think what you see before you is language that reflected what the broader body was comfortable with, and that's what was submitted to you on first review. I think certainly we have opportunity to receive feedback from the board and strengthen that language in ways that aligns, I think, more intentionally and clearly to some of the other work that's been happening across the state to advance

our understanding and articulate a clear vision and expectation for a culturally competent educator workforce.

[01:35:10] And so we certainly have the ability and the expertise in the office to do that. Thank you, Leah. I think that would be really important because the work you're doing is so powerful and impactful. And as you and I have talked, and as you've presented to the board before, our work is one part of this process and what we bring to the table, but it's actually what happens in schools day to day and what we hold people accountable for. So now that we have an opportunity to have as a part of our evaluation, this very, very important performance standard around being culturally responsive and equitable. And that's in the standard title. I want us to be really clear

[01:35:47] that all the work we're doing and that you're doing and that we're trying to lead and that the board has been working on really is reflective there. And in a very, very intentional way, I read into it, and I see that the essence is there, but I'm also thinking of a teacher or someone who's not quite there on that journey where we need to be around what equity means, and is it that clear to them?

[01:36:07] Or is it easy to say, well, this says cultural responses, so I'm working with my Latino students, and I'm improving and helping them, and so I should have met the standard when I'm not paying attention to my students with disabilities who are not doing well and not providing equitable practices for them, or vice versa the other way.

[01:36:25] I want it to be as inclusive as we can be, as clear as we can be, and really aligned to the focus that you're leading and that we're leading and the change that's needed that I'm excited about. I don't want us to miss that opportunity here and then have that in our evaluation system.

[01:36:43] And it's, again, you and I can read into this and see that it's there. I'm trying to be as intentional and clear for every single person who is using this and will use this evaluation as a form of growth. and I hope evaluations turn into a form of growth for our employees, which is why the behavioral language is helpful. We're all on a journey. We're on a journey to get better, and we as administrators should be supporting teachers who should be supporting each other on how to grow, and I want everyone to be intentional about what we're growing towards, and so that's why I just have a little pause there, and I would love to bring back any other modifications or something

[01:37:19] to better meet that intentionality. Thank you, Mr. Gecker. That's all my questions and comments. Dr. Moran, President Gecker, may I just respond briefly? Of course, yes. In addition to what you see in the new standard six, we put in front of the work group three options for how to address equitable practices and culturally responsive teaching. Option one was to have a new standard, such as the one that you see, along with very selective indicators

[01:37:54] embedded in the other standards, in some of the other standards, where we felt it was especially important to highlight that across the standard of planning, for example, or instructional delivery. Second option was to have the standard and to embed indicators that rightly would belong under this culturally responsive teaching equitable practices standard in every other standard, in all other standards that ultimately was not accepted by the work group feeling that it was

[01:38:30] too much overlap the third option was not to have a third to have a new standard but instead to fully integrate all of the indicators across the existing seven standards that too was ultimately rejected by the work group. So the point is, what we settled on is that you're looking at the standard itself, but if we

were to unpack carefully many of the other standards, you would see there is already an emphasis in as behavioral, in as much behavioral terminology as we could make

[01:39:09] it, issues about equitable practices, inclusive teaching in the other standards themselves. So So there's even somewhat of a bigger dose than what you're seeing in this first dose. Thank you for that additional information, Dr. Strong.

[01:39:26] And I'm actually glad that we did have a separate standard. I'm glad the work group did bring that forth because of the intentionality of it all. And again, I'm very supportive of this, so my comments to everyone is not being not supportive. I just want to make sure that we're as succinct and intentional as possible before we adopt this, that we include every bit of language that we can, thinking not how we think, you know, those of us that are engaged in deep in this work around equity, we understand what this is about.

[01:39:53] But I want to think about someone who's growing in this area and helping them to see that roadmap of where they need to go, and being held accountable towards that in a way. So it's a friendly suggestion, Dr. Strong, India, and Patty, to how we can bring back some more clarity and intentionality.

[01:40:12] So thank all three of you for your responses. And we'll be happy to go back and work with Leah again and engage you in the conversation as well, Dr. Duran. And we will make some tweaks and refinement to that language and bring it back for final review.

[01:40:32] So we very much appreciate your comments. Thank you. Thank you. Yeah, and I'll just add Dr. Duran. Leah and I have already discussed some stronger language, But we wanted the first look at this to be exactly what the work group approved before the department made any further credits.

[01:40:50] And so we'll certainly work with the board over the next two months to get that section in alignment with how you'd like. - Appreciate that very much, Dr. Ling. Thank you, President Gecker. - Dr. Wilson. - Thank you. I think Ms. Holton's hand was up before mine.

[01:41:05] - I'm sorry, I thought I saw yours too. - Yeah, you do, but I think Ms. Holton. - Ms. Holton. - I defer, I'll go after you. We are a polite group. Thank you, Anne. So just a couple of things. Some along the lines of what Dr. Duran suggested.

[01:41:23] Earlier today, we heard the presentation from Jenna Conway on the early learning standards. There's a section there that talks about culturally responsive educators, I think is the title there. I think as we are expanding our work around cultural responsiveness, we should be consistent across all platforms, all offices, all language that we use.

[01:41:46] So if we could just crosswalk that and make sure that as appropriate, we are consistent. Second thing is in standard six, thinking about the responsibility that we are identifying for teachers.

[01:42:02] I know that the work around principal and superintendent standards is to come, but there's also a level of responsibility and certainly differentiated responsibility that leaders have to ensuring that culturally responsive and equitable practices are being seen.

[01:42:19] So I'll look forward to seeing that. And I think it will be important to ensure that teachers, because this is the first set of standards that we will roll out, understand that the support they need in order to do this work is coming, right?

[01:42:39] So it's not just a matter of saying do this, but how do I do it? what is the support so i think being sure that we are intentional about that conversation um and then the last uh two things um dr strong i think i heard nice to see you by the way i think i heard you say use the word fidelity and so and i can't remember exactly what the uh phrasing was all around that but it made me think about um you know our role one of the concerns we have as a board

[01:43:13] is certainly to ensure that our students have the quality of instruction consistent quality of instruction across the board and so the fidelity with which building leaders and superintendents are then applying these standards or reviewing these standards or assessing these standards is really important so i i'm imagining that in the change in language to more behavioral that there is some nod toward how we can gauge quality assurance if you will or fidelity of implementation in some ways so I don't know if you could speak a little bit to that um yes good to see you Dr

[01:43:51] Wilson and let me say that the the issue that you're bringing to us is I think it has to have a two-part answer number one the standards themselves the handbook that we create must be able to speak to quality standard practices that should be implemented. So not just reliability, but validity as well. Are we doing the right things? Are we putting in the right language?

[01:44:20] And I feel very confident about the Virginia Standards. With my work in other states, I often consider the Virginia Standards and the work that we've done previously and the work that we have here as being an excellent model for that. The second part of the issue is implementation.

[01:44:41] You can have the best plan in the world and you know as a former superintendent this is true, but without fidelity of implementation you don't achieve anything and that speaks to training. Dr. Lane has explicitly in our conversations even from the very beginning has been keenly aware of the importance of training uh patty and i have talked about it many times and that's where we have training built into this system and in part of the training will be not only new orientation

[01:45:16] but also a first effort at inter-rater reliability most recently just this month in the conversation that dr lane miss pitts and i had and jenny tonison with my company was about follow-up training. One of the failures that happens in many states is to have initial training and believe that it is taken, that it's set. It's almost like getting the first dose for the coronavirus. I used

[01:45:51] that word earlier, but that's not enough. We really need to have follow-up training, and Dr. Lane has expressed interest in how we might do that. That's how we get to fidelity across 130 something school divisions in 1900 plus schools thank you that's all i have dr deck or mr geck i'm giving the honorary degree degree right i always feel inferior in this crowd of doctors

[01:46:21] so the honorary degree would be nice uh ms holton uh secretary holton and um uh thank you um uh mr gecker and thank you uh miss pitts and dr strong uh and the work of the task force where we're grateful for you all having helped us get started on this process uh i have a couple of sets of questions um and then possibly a comment based on what i hear my first set of questions is i'm

[01:46:55] trying to understand how much gets mandated here or versus strongly recommended and and that has to do with and i know we we're reluctant in virginia to mandate but i also think that our board goal of getting some consistent evaluation across the state such that we can use it to guide state and local uh regarding equity and resource distribution for instance uh may may mean that we need to be a little uh that we may need to look at options to uh that will help uh promote

[01:47:32] uniformity and with that in mind am i right that this um instrument does not these guidelines do not require do not require formal observations do not require student surveys do not require self-evaluation recommend strongly but does not require any of those is that right the Dr. Lane and Patti, would you like me to speak to this first or would you prefer?

[01:48:07] Yeah, Dr. Strong, I'll fill in after you go first. Okay. I was just looking for a section in the code. If I can, here we go. 22.1-253 requires that all the school division, that the state board adopt guidelines for uniform standards for teachers, administrators, and principals.

[01:48:31] and that teacher evaluations include regular observation and evidence that instruction is aligned with the school's curriculum, as well as measures of student academic progress. There are some non-negotiables in state code.

[01:48:47] And one of those, Ms. Holton, is observation. So of all the data sources, observation must occur. In the statewide survey that we conducted, we found that 100% of the school divisions do use those. but we also know very clearly from study after study that observation alone is flawed.

[01:49:10] And consequently, the best evaluation work that's aimed at teacher support and improvement will use multiple data sources. And that's why we have four specific data sources included in the guidelines and why we will feature those in the actual implementation.

[01:49:28] - But I think I understand correctly that you do not mandate. I hear you observations are part of the code and therefore mandated here but but the student surveys and self-avail they are they are not mandated and am I also right is there anything in the guidelines about pre-observation conference or post-observation conference which I understand to be part of the best practice for how to do observations well we have information about pre-conferences that's optional and actually the research on pre-conferences has pros and cons to it not in every instance would we want to have a pre-conference an unannounced for example an

[01:50:06] unannounced observation sometimes is much more healthy helpful and revealing than a planned observation and it's more feasible to implement and am i right that the research shows that student surveys is one of the most helpful observation tools excuse me evaluation tools and the short answer is yes absolutely but we're seeing that 61 percent don't use student surveys at all and there's nothing in these guidelines that changes anything about we encourage them and you've given

[01:50:40] some great instrument suggestions but there's nothing that changes the expect that will necessarily change that 61 percent not using student surveys the code doesn't speak to this issue and we do not mandate it. We strongly recommend it and the research is just the empirical research is absolutely clear that students are some of the best evaluators of teacher effectiveness. Ultimately I hope that and I understand we've got a phase three to come but

[01:51:18] ultimately I hope we will look at what some other states have done both to get to great evaluations and to get to more consistent evaluations across the state and maybe there's a way we can look to if we have a default instrument for instance approach such that we provide an instrument that would include student surveys but that would allow localities to opt out under certain circumstances with with justification etc but i'm i uh let me ask my last set of questions and then

[01:51:54] comment and then i'd appreciate your response my last set of questions is about on this question that uh dr duran and raised and and um that you all have discussed a little bit on the embedded

uh cultural responsiveness uh standard versus um single uh standard on cultural responsiveness is that something that uh there are national best that the national best practices can help us can help inform us on you know either from what's going on in other uh schools or more generally in

[01:52:28] hr evaluation work what what are what do we know about what the research shows about the most effective way to help our teachers uh be become more culturally responsive embedding in a single standard versus i'm a little bit worried that embedding it in a single standard as opposed to as you said the task force considered also the option of of embedding it in in multiple different standards uh i'm a little worried that oh that's going to be oh oh cultural responsiveness is over here and not um not uh given its due in all the other standards and and i'd just be interested is

[01:53:07] is there any national best practice or research that can inform our work here in turn miss holton in terms of evaluation no this is too new there has been work going on for for decades and that has been uh accentuated much uh much more recently in terms of culturally responsive practices and we have taken that research to design what we have but in terms of how to develop the evaluation

[01:53:40] system, we don't know on this issue. I can give you, though, a more generic answer that's not specifically about this new standard in terms of overall practice. And that is, no single standard is standalone. They're all interrelated. If we take the learning environment standard, it overlaps with instructional delivery and vice versa. So it's somewhat artificial to create standards. There is just the totality of quality teaching practice, but to bring sense and

[01:54:15] sensibility to it, to give operational definition to it, we must create the standards. And that's the real value of having this new standard. There is also danger of having too much overlap among all of the standards because it's double dipping for good or for bad, for advantage or disadvantage to a teacher. And we want to protect the best interest of teachers. That's another reason to be very cautious about too great of an overlap. For example, we could put planning in every single standard, but we chose primarily to locate it in one place. And that's the model that we're

[01:54:53] following here. So, and I'm sorry, I did remember one more area of questioning I meant to ask you about that. Thank you for all that so far. Our portrait of an educator that we've been through some significant effort on in Virginia over the last couple of years. How did that play into the work of the task force here, and can you crosswalk some of the highlights of Portrait of Educator to the evaluation system that's being proposed today? With your permission, I would like to defer to

[01:55:26] miss pitts or to dr lane and and but just state that we attempted to consider all of the ongoing interlocking uh parts of the fabric of the the work on what quality educators do so we did we considered not only the portrait of the educator but every other possible uh source that we had, such as the work on cultural responsiveness. So with that, if I may defer

[01:55:57] to you, Dr. Lane? Yeah, I'll take that, Patty, if you want me to. And I actually have a comment going back to one of your other questions at the end. I'll make sure to try to remember as well. But certainly in all of the work we do, the profile of a graduate, the profile of a classroom, the profile of a teacher, our center and our thoughts. And each of the individuals that we bring to the work group, you know, we hope that they have a background and the broader knowledge of what's going on. But with the profile of an educator specifically, one of the major

[01:56:35] threads in that profile is a focus on equitable practices. And so, you know, whereas the scope of this phase two was really narrowly focused on cultural competency and the summative rating piece, you know, we embedded that with intentional thought about those profiles. But we really see the opportunity to take this work to the next level being in phase three. And so that's, you know, being completely honest, it was a priority, but it wasn't the primary priority. We see that as a primary priority of the way we move into phase three. And so I'll stop there and see if

[01:57:12] you have any other questions on that, but I would like to address the consistency issue, if you'll allow me. Please. Okay, I'll go ahead. Yeah. So in the code section that Dr. Strong was referencing uh you know he mentioned the requirement for uh you know alignment to the curriculum regular observation so on and so forth that code section also has a sentence in it that says that each division's uh evaluation system must be consistent with your guidelines doesn't have to say they have to use our guidelines exactly but it does say it has to be consistent it also says that there has to be an overall summative rating as a side note if you don't

[01:57:49] know that. And so one of the things that you could do, and this is because I've had some offline conversations, I've been thinking about this related to some of your thoughts specifically, Ms. Holden. One of the things the board could do is you could create, you know, expectations for what consistency looks like. I don't know that I would do that here in phase two. I think that's more of a phase three type project but let's say that the board uh ultimately found uh uh you know student surveys to be so important you could make a very direct statement that to maintain consistency

[01:58:27] with our guidelines at a minimum you must do these things uh and and you know and i would defer to susan on this potentially you could even begin to regulate the evaluation system rather than do it uh through through guidelines but the code does does say uh guidelines specifically and so those those are some options to think through i think you'd have to get oag opinion based on whatever you decided to do i i rather than talking in hypotheticals i think they'd want to see specifics but uh but uh that's just a train of thought for you on that notion ms holton i wanted to just add

[01:59:05] as well to your question about national sort of best practice around cultural competency, efficacy, or evaluation for cultural competency. What Dr. Strong said is true, right? There is, there is, this is an emerging field of practice, though a critically important field of practice.

[01:59:22] So it's happening while we're doing it, while we're building it to a certain extent. With this change in our guidelines for teacher evaluation, Virginia will be a national leader in establishing both accountability and clear expectation around what we want to see um our educators produce for students in the commonwealth and so there are some districts in different states and in different places who have begun this work but to really set forth a statewide expectation of what this looks like um really does position virginia as a national leader um that said that doesn't mean we don't do

[02:00:01] it right we don't move forward and um and push in an aggressive way for what we know is going to matter in terms of producing better outcomes for students i'll also say that this isn't happening in a vacuum against other things that we're doing or other projects that are underway and i think it's important to also um discuss this in the frame of that context right so we have legislation currently moving through the general assembly that mandates professional development and the board will have to decide what that means and what that looks like what is the professional development for educators and school leaders who will be doing these evaluations what is the

[02:00:36] minimum criteria that that the board is going to set forth and so this is one part of sort of that bigger picture um and that the bigger work that we're doing as a state to not just articulate expectations but also to embed accountability to the expectations that we have for a high quality public education in the state well thank you all mr gecker if i can take the floor for just another minute i i'd just like to comment i do think there's been some good work here but i'm very

[02:01:10] very worried that the work in phase two is both simultaneously too much and too little i think this final product is really it's still an outdated approach to teacher evaluation it's nowhere near what we want to be able to support and I've you know I mean we need to have a conversation about what we as the board think are the primary goals of teacher evaluation but I would submit that one of them is supporting and retaining good teachers so that that teacher improvement piece is really

[02:01:46] in light of our current teacher shortages in light of where we are on um uh on the importance of teachers overall i really feel like the teacher support and retention is the probably the most important piece and that to do that well we would want a system that is really fundamentally about teacher improvement so starts with a self-evaluation and i would be prepared right now to mandate that it start with a self-evaluation i do think the research supports that student surveys are extremely helpful criteria, whether we mandate them or strongly encourage them through the use

[02:02:25] of a default instrument. I think that when we do observations, recognizing Dr. Strong that sometimes there are reasons to do unscheduled observations, but that the norm ought to be a pre-observation conference so the teacher can have input as to what the observation is going to focus on, on what the teacher is doing, or it may have been that last year's evaluation would have helped set clear goals that the observations will then be consistent with.

[02:02:56] So I think it can be much more oriented towards teacher improvement. I also am not at all clear that this advances our goals significantly on making teacher evaluations useful in terms of providing more consistency statewide so as to guide state and local policy making and resource allocation.

[02:03:19] Now, I don't really know whether that goal is achievable. And I think we as a board need to decide how much priority to put on that goal. But if we do wanna be able to use these teacher evaluations to say, for instance, to see and respond to data on all of our jurisdictions getting equal access to effective teachers, I think we're gonna need to mandate much more consistency.

[02:03:45] And I don't know whether we wanna go there or not. I think, so all of this is to say, I think it's urgent that we begin our phase three work and that the phase three work be the most important piece. And I'm worried that this phase two work could almost by looking like we're solving the big problems when except for the adding of the equity, I'm not sure we really are, may slow down.

[02:04:14] I mean, we've got to do training on the interim, et cetera, rather than accelerate the work into phase three. So I'm not sure the right resolution of all of that. Some of it is even just around messaging. And one suggestion on messaging is that maybe we roll out phase two guidelines.

[02:04:32] Maybe we call them interim right from the start. And maybe we roll them out as part of the beginning of phase three, rather than as a distinct, that we announced the beginning of phase three. And in the meanwhile, here are interim guidelines. So I'm getting into the thinking aloud part here and I'm sure that's not helpful.

[02:04:53] But my main concern is that this is on the one hand too much and on the other hand too little to be technical edits. And that will prevent us from getting into a time when we really look at what are the national best practices.

[02:05:09] 'Cause there's been a lot of development, not on the equity space specifically I understand what Dr. Strong and Leah are telling us on that but more generally there's been a lot of national research a lot of best practices work we've heard from Linda Darley Hammond for instance about some of it on how we use evaluations to support our overall goals and let's dive into that work as quickly as possible and let's make sure what we're doing on this very very limited basis doesn't deter doesn't doesn't um

[02:05:47] impact negatively the the longer term work okay anybody else uh dr bexton is that are you raising your hand yes okay hi good morning um i want to uh try to offer some some lucid thought here i'm kind of connecting a few dots in my mind but uh so uh you know from an adult education standpoint you know running the training organization at newport new shipbuilding we we deal with

[02:06:23] uh instructor evaluations uh quite intensely and so just some perspectives that i'm bringing from that that aspect of work uh coupled with the fact that i'm not as informed uh other than this these guidelines that have been provided and revised as far as the history or what has been tried or what is considered acceptable as far as a practice relative to teacher evaluation. So bear with me on that. But a couple of thoughts and questions about number one, when I look at the guidelines,

[02:07:00] the initial and the revised, I don't see a whole lot about mentorship. And in regards to that, you know my my my thought process is is okay what what opportunities or guidelines may there be to really strengthen the language around number one peer-to-peer mentorship um because we we find that very valuable uh when instructors are really at the same level and at and actually at a different level i'll get to in a minute are really providing that peer-to-peer a little bit more comfortable

[02:07:34] environment uh as far as instruction um along along same lines i tie that to uh you know the discussions and the guidelines revisions we put in place for our standard standards of quality and you know number two in that was teacher leader and mentor program and i pulled it up because uh really to to uh miss holton's point one of the statements in that got in that document was you know comprehensive mentorship and induction programs can improve teacher retention and accelerate the professional growth of a teacher so we made that a an affirmation in our

[02:08:11] soqs um but unless i'm missing it i'm not really seeing a strong presence of mentorship in the guidelines what i do see uh is uh you know a reference to the use of optimal means of communication i'm sorry you know i see a reference to teacher evaluation should serve as a channel to provide targeted feedback professional development coaching and mentorship to our teachers which is you know affirming its value but when we get into even the evaluation criteria for the different

[02:08:45] performance standards the only place i see mentors as a reference to teacher improvement is in standard seven uh might be eight now i'm not might be getting that mixed up but basically teacher professionalism when and i see it only in the rating of a highly effective teacher not in an effective teacher um and so it makes me question well wouldn't mentorship have implications for almost if not all of the standards uh teacher planning instruction

[02:09:20] knowledge uh learning and and and would it only occur in highly effective and not an effective would we not consider that as a standard of quality to be something standard at an effective teacher level

um that we would want to use as an assessment so um i guess my first thought is how much discussion um was had by the work groups relative to mentorships am i missing some stronger level of intent in the guidelines but i think there's an opportunity here to to better connect

[02:09:56] the impact of teacher mentorships and teacher leaders to how teacher development happens. So that's my first thought. Under the new area added to the proposed guidelines, under growth and improvement, there is a statement, certainly it could be strengthened, but it does say that teacher evaluation should serve as a channel to provide targeted feedback, professional development, coaching and mentorship to our teachers. So that was one of the sections that was actually added

[02:10:31] to the document that's before you today and you are absolutely correct it is also referenced in under the professionalism standard as well. So it is mentioned but it is not mentioned in three or four areas in the document itself. And the only thing I'll add to that is there are also guidelines on teacher mentorship that kind of sit parallel to this. In fact, in the JLARC report, they reference some ways that we would update the methodology and guidance there. And of course,

[02:11:10] you know, we have a broad vision from the board to build an SOQ around this with significant resources, which also has not been funded at this time. And then the last piece I'd say is, we really see mentorship being a part of the professional development work. And some of the thinking if you recall dating back 18 months is we want to reshuffle our professional development work away from points only to focusing on specific areas and that's an opportunity to address mentorship as well so the evaluation is just one of maybe a couple places the board could

[02:11:45] take on more work there but i think it's a great okay i i appreciate that perspective i uh uh so i guess i just want to make sure i'm clear on what i'm hearing do we feel that we've we've connected that that thread sufficiently in this in this work or do we think there's some more opportunity there oh i i would say we're taking your feedback and we're going to make enhancements based on what we hear today so i i would say we're we're taking your feedback and and we'll come back in march

[02:12:18] with more thoughts on that great so yes we can do more i think is more specific okay um my second thought deals with the concept we refer to at at the shipyard as uh value stream evaluations basically who down the value stream is really going to be impacted by whether or not this training was effective or not and uh we uh you know in in training in general kirk patrick's model of evaluation there's typically four levels of that the first level is the the learner

[02:12:51] themselves how did the learning impact them second level is um an assessment you know is that have has their have their knowledge improved have their skills improved can they show any proficiency that's level two and then level three is um the application of those skills so someone else down the value stream is evaluating whether or not that retention stayed um and it's still applicable has there been any growth and so i when i apply that you know shipyard or not even shipyard but but that more elevated approach to learning, I guess you could say that we use in the industry today

[02:13:28] from a learning organization standpoint to K-12, it makes me think about that teacher down the line, that fourth grade teacher. - Four, two, four. - I don't think that's me, check all my devices. But that teacher down the line, that fourth grade teacher that now should have seen, should be experiencing the results of what that third grade teacher has been teaching.

[02:13:52] It gets back to the peer-to-peer, it's a little bit different. Just curious if that approach or that model is something that would even be considered or appropriate or ever have been or what? I'd have to defer to Dr. Strong on this from a research basis. Dr. Axton, both of your points I think are really interesting. If I could very quickly go back to your original point, I strongly concur that the value in evaluation

[02:14:27] is in support growth and development and to do that one place that we see some business in america going large companies like google and others is in coaching and not just mentoring but in coaching and that is a different framework we allude to that we get into it to a degree we highlight the importance of professional growth and development, not only in the document,

[02:15:02] but in the process of the evaluation and in the training. But it does not go as far as you're advocating, and I would absolutely support in terms of coaching and mentoring and tying all the various pieces together. Much more likely, that would be a key feature of the phase three.

[02:15:27] But in laying the groundwork for that, we still change this document pretty substantially to feature growth and development, and we set it in multiple places and multiple times. Additionally, we have prepared to roll out with this fact sheets.

[02:15:47] They're not part of the formal system, and there's materials that you haven't seen yet on how evaluation can be used to improve teacher performance. different ones how it can be used for teacher retention how it can be used for student achievement so downstreaming if you will how it can be used to coincide with meaningful pd and i think that's the real flavor i i i think i'm hearing from you on on both of your points um to me downstreaming

[02:16:21] is it's a business concept, but it is one that is applicable in education. It's embedded in this system and it has been, but it can be highlighted much better. How do you have alignment from what happens with the value-added impact of a first grade teacher with a fourth grade teacher? And if you, for, I mean, just in very practical terms, I don't mean to be saying too much here,

[02:16:47] But in very practical terms, if a child has an ineffective Algebra I teacher, I can pretty well guarantee you that's the last math class that kid's ever going to take, if at all possible, because of the impact of that teacher in value added.

[02:17:06] On the other hand, if that child has a teacher who is awakening and opens that child's mind to what can happen in math, what a difference it makes downstream. I think it is absolutely essential what we do now and whatever you choose to do with phase three looks at this critical issue of how the impact of what is the impact.

[02:17:31] If evaluation has no impact, don't do it. Just get out of the business of evaluation if it doesn't have an impact. So I really concur with where you're leaning, where you're wanting to go. That doesn't answer all the questions for today. We can certainly highlight more on professional development. It appears to me, though, that has to be, if I'm hearing everything, every conversation I've had with the state superintendent, I think speaks to this, that the issue of coaching, mentoring, professional growth, teacher support is what this game is all about.

[02:18:06] Thank you. I appreciate your comments and context to what I was trying to communicate. So thank you. No, Ms. Holton had her hand up. We've been doing this two hours, 15 minutes, and I'm getting texts from people saying, can we take a break?

[02:18:24] Would it be possible, Dr. Strong, for you to hang on if we took a 10-minute break? Absolutely. And, you know, the rest of the board, is that okay? This is clearly an important item for us. It's core to what we're doing next. And so I would like to not give it a short treatment because we need a break.

[02:18:42] So what if we're back at 1225? Is that okay? Okay. We're going to stand and recess then.

[02:20:34] I'm going to do a whole lot of work in advance, and I'm going to start on it.

[02:22:27] I'll hire not me, but I'm going to pay somebody to start doing a lot of the background research on this. They have to have a lot of the same elements.

[02:22:50] Yeah, Dr. Strong. In fact, the same all requires certain elements.

[02:23:09] It would have been easier. You may want to mute your lines while we're doing the break. Patty, I just muted him. Oh, thank you.

[02:28:07] Yeah, we'll get started in a minute.

[02:30:11] I don't see Dr. Derong, Ms. Holton. - Dr. Mann's not back yet. - Dr. Mann, yes, thank you. - There she is. - I'm here, I'll just turn my camera on in a minute, sorry. - Okay, I think everybody is back 'cause Ms. Houlton did turn her camera on briefly.

[02:30:33] - Yep. - And she was here. - And I think when we left, Ms. Houlton was gonna take the floor and ask a few questions or follow up on some things. - Well, so shall I jump in, Mr. Decker?

[02:30:50] - Yes. So I'm really just, I think I've shared the thoughts I need to share, except one response to Keisha, which is just remembering how much thought has been put into how to effectively support quality workers in the corporate sector as part of the kinds of knowledge that the national world on teacher evaluation is trying to figure out how to take advantage of, and we should.

[02:31:18] There's so much good thinking going on there and how we tie this evaluation work into professional development and other formal and informal forms of development, all of which is, as I said before, I'm really eager to get us to phase three and to make it clear to the public that we're ready to take a major stab at doing this work and aligning it with our work on portrait of an educator,

[02:31:50] portrait of a graduate and on professional development, etc. So all of that, I'm just trying to figure out how to best get us to that work and not have this work derail that work at all or forego options for that work. And I do wonder, I tossed out the suggestion earlier and be interested in others' responses, but what about the idea, instead of getting too bogged down on language on this one what about we accept the task force's good work pretty much as is maybe there's some wording changes that can come out of the discussions today but try to push it forward

[02:32:28] next month for final but label it interim and roll it out with an announcement of the beginning of phase three so that there's no lack of clarity that this is but a step on the larger pathway and i don't know that that's the magic right way to do it i'm just tossing that out as a possibility. I think we all agree that we've got bigger work to come. I think that's really the heart of this issue, right, is that where does this fit into the bigger work? You know, our comprehensive work plan has, as I think, item two, teacher and building leadership. You know,

[02:33:06] we dealt with equity and pieces of teachers, you know, sort of in the first round, we issued, we prescribed the SOQs as a result of that work. And sort of the next natural thing for us to turn to is, you

know, a more comprehensive look at teachers in building leadership, both of whom, you know, through the research, both of which through the research have got, you know, really the most significant, you know, impact on student outcomes. And really, you know, from my perspective, and I've said this a lot while I've been on this board, you know, the goal is to provide better

[02:33:44] outcomes for our students. And everything else is a tool to that end, right? You know, having effective teachers is a tool that gets us to the goal of better outcomes for our kids and then the question is how excuse me how do we improve teacher effectiveness and you know dr strong something you said was well if the evaluations aren't going anywhere or aren't making a value add why are we doing them and honestly uh you know as i and this is not about the work of the task force but it is

[02:34:18] about how this fits into the overall system if we don't link this to professional development if we don't use this to set the expectations of what ought to be done and frankly if we don't use this to bring more uniformity throughout the commonwealth uh of you know expectations from the board about how kids ought to be taught and you know and brings up correctly teacher retention you know in my experience on the business side of the world people like places where they get feedback and are given opportunities to improve and here it seems like we're giving feedback and

[02:34:56] this is not a criticism again of this piece of work because it you know the conversation is going to morph now into the broader discussion of what does the board's work plan really look like around that area which includes that piece which is teacher evaluation and to ann's point also you You know, it's always great going after Ann speaking because she says everything I wanted to say normally, and I don't really have to elaborate much.

[02:35:23] But, you know, James and Dr. Strong and Patty, you're going to have to give me a better feel for if we do this, how much work does it impose upon the locals? If we think that later on we're going, you know, and do we want to do that if we think that later on we're going to make changes to an evaluation system based upon what we find might make it more effective.

[02:35:51] You know, we talk about observations, you know, I know some board members have talked preliminarily about, you know, other places that require training for observers as opposed to just, you know, you know, principals walking in or superintendents walking in, you know, does that make it more effective?

[02:36:11] can we mandate, and I know James just sort of said no, student evaluations, right? I mean, he says, well, we can only do guidelines, you know, in the scope of where we're going, if we believe that, as an example, student evaluations are an important tool, can the board mandate it? Can we effectively link this? And, you know, what are we going to do with the whole field of professional development, where, as I understand it, we really don't have any mandates as to you know if a teacher is considered weak in area x that we be are able to mandate and

[02:36:46] provide training in area x to improve the effectiveness of that teacher and so you know i don't know the answer to this uh much as ann just said i don't think we ought to be doing a lot if we think that the next field of endeavor for the board which i think this is going to be that is the whole teacher effectiveness piece uh is going to incorporate this um i don't want to put a lot out that makes people do have a lot of changes and then say oh gee two years from now we're going to shift gears because we now have a more holistic approach to the issue of teacher

[02:37:21] effectiveness and retention like i said i'm way outside my field here so uh those in the education universe are going to have to explain this to me a little bit better i'll take uh go ahead miss pitts my first response is that i think we do need to do something now because i think it's critically important that we include in the performance standards culturally responsive teaching and equitable practices and i don't think we want to wait until we have a development of a

[02:37:59] new system to incorporate that in the expectations on for teachers principals and superintendents across the state that is the primary and major change in the document that you have before you dr lane patty i think you you kind of said what i was going to say i i think that it we we all want to get to this much more impactful teacher growth and evaluation system and uh i do believe that

[02:38:34] will take a few years uh i mean procurement alone will take a long time at the state if any of you know how that goes and but i don't think our students can wait for us to begin to make uh culturally relevant practices in their classroom a priority and so you know we the the scope of phase two was really limited uh around that now in terms of how much work that is going to be for locals i i i won't say that that it won't be a lot of work but it's really important work and it's work that's already starting to go on in their school divisions and so i i think that this will

[02:39:11] actually support the efforts that they have to move things forward in a very intentional way which is why I think getting the language very intentional, as you mentioned, is important. And then the other thing that I would say is, you know, there's a bill certainly being supported by the governor's office around, you know, requiring evaluations to have some of these components in addition to the training piece. And I wouldn't want to slow down our progress on phase three to come back in three months and go right back into this conversation on embedding this in the evaluation when we're ready to do that and show that we're leading on this and so those are my

[02:39:50] general thoughts on your question Mr. Gecker but your point around you know now that the board has finished SOQs and SOAs and everything else this is absolutely number one priority for the department and certainly we hope will be number one priority for the board to get it right we just want to do it slowly enough that we truly get it right and we allow the research basis to grow with us as we do it yes dr duran and i would just like to double down and echo what ms pitts and dr lane said and i think that even as we move forward in this very important work as ms holton was you know talking

[02:40:25] about and dr pekstein some of the elements with regards to mentorship and coaching this element of what's been done here which is to include cultural responsive and equitable practices is not something that's going to change over that work i would hope as one board member i would which felt strong and one board member I would say this is something that needs to be an integral part of that. I do think that the change also with regards to revising the rating levels from exemplary, proficient, et cetera, to highly effective, effective, approaching effective, ineffective will help us on that next trajectory of where we need to go with regards to getting us

[02:41:03] to have evaluations truly be about supporting teacher performance and growth and helping us use evaluation as a tool and not as a got you measure. So I do think there are some initial steps of those two that have been done in this work. That's not to say that I agree, I won't repeat everything that's already been said about the ongoing long-term work that needs to happen.

[02:41:26] But this to me, I viewed it as I looked through this and as I listened to Dr. Strong and Ms. Pitts, I viewed this as a beginning step towards that and a necessary one and one that's in the right direction. I

know it might sound simple, but to me, as a practitioner using this, I think it's very substantive, that change from exemplary to highly effective. I think that is going to help us on this path that we're all seeking, that I've heard all of my colleagues comment on. And again, the cultural responsive and equitable practices piece is so necessary. Yes, as Dr. Lane said, for some divisions, it will be extra work, but for many school divisions, they're beginning this,

[02:42:04] And I think we'll embolden even more and prioritize and raise the level of what I've always said, you know, what monitor, what's monitors gets done. And if we have an effective tool that we can use in that way, I think that this is on the right track. So I'm kind of saying what my colleagues have said, but also wanting to add that I am supportive of where we're going.

[02:42:25] I do think NAIS 3 is going to be much more in-depth and more substantive work. but I don't wanna pause or I wanna as one member say that this, I acknowledge that Ms. Pitts and Dr. Strong that this has been a positive step in that way.

[02:42:40] And I think it is more connected than not. And I think it does put us on the right trail. We're not at the end, but it's on the right trail. - Dr. Wilson. - Just a suggestion for framing. So I appreciate Ms. Holton's suggestion about kind of nodding toward a bridge, you know, So we're moving forward, but we're headed, we're not going, there's not a definitive start and stop, right?

[02:43:07] This is ongoing, this continuous thing. So maybe one way to do that, it's a question or a suggestion. In the front matter of the guidelines themselves, could we talk about the profile of an educator? Is that a place for that conversation to begin to outline all of the various pieces that we're talking about?

[02:43:29] need for professional development mentoring and coaching and all so put all of that into the front matter of this document as one piece of a bigger hole that's going to then be fleshed out over time that may help indicate to those in the field we're not done but it also then allows us to continue moving forward on some of these items that are brought forward with the revisions that we have in front of us president gecker yes miss davis thought as an elementary school principal i think

[02:44:05] we are right on track and i echo everyone's statements this is a great time to do this it's a great time to move forward and i fully support what we're doing and i just appreciate everyone's discussions and points that you're bringing up and to your points i totally agree with you that we need to be thinking outside of the box moving forward and and really truly looking at what more we can do but at this point in time stage two i think we're on point if i may just i if i can just

[02:44:40] endorse um uh jamel's uh dr wilson's suggestion of adding some front language and and i would also suggest adding the word interim to the guidelines and and that front language could say that this set up changes contains two important steps forward on cultural responsiveness and on the effectiveness language and some technical edits. The board affirms its intent to expeditiously

[02:45:15] work towards a wholesale new look in light of Port River graduate, in light of professional development requirements in light of national best practices. But if the department is comfortable with that approach, I can certainly live with that approach. And the one thing we don't want to do is slow anything down on that. So I'm all for getting this round done. I think the task force has done good work on this round. I don't mean to take away from that. And I thank Dr. Duran for reminding us that. So we can affirm that work and also include language

[02:45:49] so that nobody is um surprised we're going to train them on these changes but we're also going to start right away on the next round all right dr man actually thank you president gecker i think the use of interim um was helpful because i certainly wondered um about the um multiple methods comment i do think that when i when i first read uh the materials and saw that the science talked about the importance of multiple methods but really it was being highly recommended

[02:46:24] and I mean that was a conversation that happened very early on with Ms. Fulton's comments so interim satisfies it because I thought once you approve this that means that's done and you don't get to go back to that you're focusing more on the system so I certainly support all that's been been said about a way forward okay well this item is here on first review so we'll have another chance that well i guess in march to uh talk about this again uh appreciate everybody's time and effort on this uh you know a lot of the comments of the board here are really not geared

[02:47:01] to the work product but geared to where we view ourselves and this topic in the context of where we view ourselves right now and so although some of it comes off as you know we're questioning the work that's not really what's that issue what's that issue is uh you know as we seek to you know facilitate having teachers be more effective throughout the commonwealth how does this piece fit into that overall whole and so we're very appreciative of this my expectation is that in march we will move forward with it i think there's some work to do between now and march to add some

[02:47:38] things to the document to make it more clear again not what the document is doing but where the document fits into the overall framework of where we're going is that helpful uh miss pitts And Dr. Strong, I hope. Yes, thank you very much.

[02:47:55] Thank you, Mr. Geckerman, board members. We appreciate the feedback. Okay. Well, thank you all. That was item G of Z. Remember, we have a, we didn't go into the Greek letters this time, but we did finish the normal, our alphabet anyway. I guess that shouldn't be so Eurocentric.

[02:48:12] We finished our alphabet. And so we're going to move on, I think, unless there's anything else that anybody's just burning to say. I don't see anybody, so we will move on to item H. And thank you all very much.

[02:48:28] First review of an addendum and waiver to Virginia's Consolidated Plan under ESSA. Dr. Malik? Thank you, President Gecker, Vice President Wilson, Dr. Lane, and members of the board.

[02:48:43] Good afternoon. I'm here to present under first review a proposed addendum and waiver to Virginia's Consolidated State Plan under the Every Student Succeeds Act.

[02:48:53] So just a little information about as a reminder of the catalyst for what we're going to discuss today in March, the United States Department of Education allowed a waiver for assessment requirements for the 2019-2020 school year, as well as a pause on accountability and school identification requirements for comprehensive support and improvement, targeted support and improvement, and additional targeted support improvement in the 2020-2021

[02:49:27] school year with the assurance that those designations from the 2019-2020 school year would be maintained for the 2020-2021 school year. It also allowed a waiver to certain reporting requirements under ESSA. So due to that waiver, USD has acknowledged that that might mean a state is unable to implement its accountability system in the fall of 2021.

[02:50:03] Therefore through that acknowledgement they have presented a streamlined state plan addendum and the purpose of the addendum is to concentrate and identify those areas that might be a concern for states due to the waiver of March 2020 and rather than a full amendment process, this puts it all in one place so that states could go in and just select those items that they

[02:50:34] need an amendment for a one-year change. The three items that Virginia would like to submit under this addendum is a shift forward of our measures of interim progress and long-term goals of a year to move the target from this year into future years. Also, to adjust a possible calculation for a three-year average and to explore a shift of the timeline for the next

[02:51:11] federal identification period which is currently set for the fall of 2021 using data from this school year so we would like to shift that a year i'll go into these three in just a little bit more detail one is the shift of the timeline for the long-term goals and measures of interim progress if you recall we have long-term goals and measures of interim progress for the achievement indicators for our federal graduation rate chronic absenteeism and progress towards english language attainment

[02:51:43] the original plan sets the long-term goals at the conclusion of the 2024 2020 i'm sorry 2023 2024 school year so this addendum would allow us to shift that one year and our measures of interim progress are the points that schools could meet in order to meet that goal and again we would be able to shift those a year as an example these this is a a snapshot of our long-term goal and measure of interim progress table for english and this is not comprehensive of course we have

[02:52:21] measures of interim progress and long-term goals for all student groups but just to give you an idea of what this might look like i just took some of those rows so if you notice the date a year of 2019 2020 is blacked out due to that waiver of march but then we would take the goals that were expected in that year and shift them forward to the 2020-21 school year etc and you'll see that our long-term goals are also shifted a year now our measures have been in progress and long-term

[02:52:59] goals under virginia consolidated state plan can be met either through a current year rate or three year rate. The three year rate in the ESSA plan for our academic indicators of reading and math include the current year and the two previous years. So the addendum would request a modification to that to designate and be more clear that it may not be the two previous years. It would be

[02:53:29] years where data is available. Now as I stated previously, the federal identification categories for school improvement are comprehensive support and improvement, targeted support and improvement, and additional targeted support and improvement. It is important to note that under Virginia's consolidated state plan, not all schools will receive a federal accountability rating. So we're only speaking to schools that would be designated within these three categories.

[02:54:00] And so the adjustment, the addendum would allow again as a shift in identification. The Virginia consolidated state plan defines the period of identification for comprehensive support and improvement and additional targeted support and improvement schools. That period of identification is every three years. If that timeline were to be maintained, we would result in the need to identify CSI and ATSI schools in the fall of 2021 using data from 2020-2021. The addendum

[02:54:39] would allow us to shift this forward one year so that the next identification cycle of CSI and ATSI schools would take place in the fall of 2022. However, there is a third identification of targeted support and improvement schools. The timeline for identification for this is not under the state's

discretion. Rather, it's codified in the every student sees that as a yearly identification so this is where the waiver would come in because it is in the every student succeeds

[02:55:17] act we cannot modify that through an addendum to the plan so we would need to request a waiver to also shift that additional identification for tsi schools so that the next identification would take place in the fall of 2021. this is primarily because our definition of tsi in the consolidated state plan is to identify consistently underperforming student groups and we feel that it would be most appropriate to to move that um a year to forego identification so that we can have two years of

[02:55:55] consistency however as i noticed it noted in the waiver of from march the schools that were identified continue to be identified this year so within the addendum we would like to make clear that we would like to offer the opportunity for atsi schools and csi schools to exit identification statuses in the fall of 2021 for the atsi schools they would need to for the student groups who are identified they would need to meet those measures of interim progress which we spoke of a little bit

[02:56:33] earlier however the csi school exit criteria would need to undergo a modification to not include accreditation status for 2021-22, chronic absenteeism rates for 2020 and 2021, and student growth rates. So that is the proposed addendum and proposed accompanying waiver for TSI school identifications. At this time, I'd like to pause for questions. Are there any questions? Thank you

[02:57:10] very much, Dr. Malik. I actually also appreciate that your microphone is much better today than yesterday so i worked on that part of reflection and improvement there you go dr wilson um julie thank you very much i think i understand what you're uh what you're proposing here um but i just want to maybe process a little bit out loud uh and and make an observation the the the flexibility that we may have and may exercise could in fact keep us from providing necessary supports to new

[02:57:49] schools and or students in those schools because we are delaying the identification of those schools for tsi support etc by a year is that it i mean it's it's kind of a the the downside perhaps of what it is we're proposing am i am i right in that yes so we would delay that that identification another year that's and in essence support for those students in those schools that may need the support so so that's for me that's something that i'm grappling i understand what we're trying to do and why it may make sense but certainly that's a kind of an unintended

[02:58:27] consequence if you will i think that's a fair point thank you what happens if we don't make the change make the request we would need to um modify our system of accountability probably to address the the last year in 2019 2020 um for the purpose of identification in the fall of 2021

[02:59:04] we would need to ensure that there are no unintended consequences of using some data that may or may not be available and we need to explain that clearly to the Department of Education. I see Shelly's popped on. She may have additional information on that.

[02:59:21] Yeah, if I may. I think in terms of Dr. Wilson's comment about support to the schools, I believe our Office of School Quality is continuing to support schools and to look at how they are performing on the various indicators um you know while accreditation is waived for example they are still working with those schools and looking at their data and making sure that they get the support they need so but not to speak for that office dr lane may want to chime in but i believe the intent is to continue to provide the the required support if i may follow

[02:59:57] up and um Dr. Lynn I know you're going to respond but I want um it is it is possible that there are that there could be additional schools that could be identified as need and students as needing support compared to the current cohort of schools that we are providing support to through TSI CSI all of the acronyms right so so I guess I'm I'm thinking Shelley about students who are schools that are currently not identified who may end up in this category of

[03:00:35] schools um who qualify for for additional assistance that's the group that i'm identified thinking about and dr lane may want to chime in but i think the intent of our new mission of the office of school quality is to look at indicators and to support schools where they need it regardless of their identification and Dr. Lane I'll stop and let you chime in. Yes we're still building that model and and and so I hesitate to get too far ahead but we're one of the models we're trying

[03:01:10] to emulate for instance is in North Carolina where you know we we build a case management system to support schools regardless of their status while we still do the compliance work with those that are under status and so I think more will come on that in the next six months we're certainly going update you on uh the jlark progress across all three studies and a lot of a lot of depth probably at the march meeting but uh but yes as as part of this new model we're building the idea will be that the part the department will be seen as providing technical assistance to all schools

[03:01:44] and that we really you know tailor intensive services to those identified anybody else have any comments or questions i just ask would there be sufficient data available and i know the answer agency know to modify the you know to not get the the timeline ship and to sort of use other data

[03:02:14] to take its place for our goals well i mean we would we would have to evaluate the data available um in our multi-tier system of course growth is gross growth is part of the model and since we did not have scores last year that would cause an issue that was is one of our multi-steps also chronic absenteeism is our only school quality and student success indicator that we could use

[03:02:51] since accreditation has been waived so those are the two items that are in our multi-tiered system of identification that we would definitely need to evaluate and if chronic asm is a concern we would not have a school quality and student success indicator so we would need to evaluate that system so i mean as i'm hearing this if we don't do this there really is no good alternative you know in terms of changing the accountability system in other words we almost have to do this

[03:03:31] and i understand i mean it's point i appreciate dr wilson's point i'm just trying to understand you know if you carry it out what else could we do and it doesn't seem like there's a good alternative to what else we can do and it's not to diminish the point just to sort of lay out the options more plainly yeah i what i would say to that is i mean we could we could go back to the drawing board and explore some more creative options but we have explored a lot of considerations and coming to these recommendations and and certainly are bringing you what we think is the best path forward and president gecker i am i am satisfied that that there is no good alternative

[03:04:12] i'm acknowledging though that there is an unintended potentially an unintended consequence absent our knowing kind of the bigger picture plan in terms of providing additional supports um so so i i understand exactly where we are um but did think it important to acknowledge the unintended consequence yeah all i'm trying to do is explore given the given the potential adverse consequences there are a way to not have it and it does not seem to be one that's uh you know that wouldn't have other issues that are potentially worse so with that having been said i guess we

[03:04:47] take this on first with you and thank everybody for their participation in that item i first review of revisions to the approval process for multi-division online providers good morning or actually afternoon dr mr kecker dr wilson dr lane and members of the board i really do appreciate your time i'll try to keep the ball rolling as fast as possible as i bring to you the first review of revisions to the proposed revisions to the approval process for multi-division providers

[03:05:26] in Virginia. What's important to understand, let me see if I can get my screen to advance here, important to understand is a little bit of background is that the multi-division online provider application and process for approval was first approved by the Board of Education in 2010 and currently there are 19 multi-division online providers in Virginia, 17 of which are private and two are public school divisions. An approved school divisions may contract with multi-approved

[03:06:04] multi-division online providers to provide online services for students in Virginia public schools. And since the inception of the first application process, a number of things in the virtual learning environment have changed and especially in the past year during the pandemic and most important in those changes were the increases in the number of students served statewide and specifically in the area of elementary students when these when the application and approval process was first

[03:06:42] approved it was really focused on providing services to secondary students in virginia and now that really has shifted to a number of elementary school students, as well as there's been a number of changes to data reporting and security requirements. So I'm going to go through just a few of the summary. This presentation is available and posted, but we'll start with the first one talking about the process itself is that currently approved MOPS will not need to reapply. It would only be for those that have expired, their approval has expired,

[03:07:21] and it'll be an ongoing monitoring each year in order to keep them approved based on the documentation that they provide. A substantive change to the process would be the requirement of staffing. So in the original language there was a focus on secondary serving secondary students which put a requirement of reasonable ratios serving students but not exceeding 150 students per FTE, per teacher.

[03:07:56] So when you talk about elementary students, there are certain requirements that are much more stringent and the student teacher ratio is smaller in elementary classrooms. These changes would require them to adhere to all standards of quality and standards of accreditation in the area of staffing.

[03:08:18] In data and reporting, it would require the approved MOPS to provide additional data in addition to what they have currently been providing and ensure it clarifies language that ensures that they're meeting state and federal requirements, including FERPA.

[03:08:39] In the world of accountability, it focuses on making sure and clarifying and ensuring that there is written policies and procedures when it comes to reporting student participation and progress, grading and reporting, and transmission of data as well as other data elements and requirements both state and federal.

[03:09:01] The original approval process included nothing on equity and so there was new language added to be sure that there is representation and affirmation of diverse groups from different rings of culture. In the area of student services there was a need to be sure that to require that in their contracts with school divisions that it is very clear and explicit

[03:09:39] upon whom the provision of services for all of these students does lie and that would include students with disabilities el students students and students coming from underrepresented populations or those in need of special services. In the area of technology it's really the focus was on updating language because of changes in technology and also in business rules when it

[03:10:12] comes to delivering content the management system data reporting and specifically being sure that support is available to parents and guardians as they help their students working in an online setting finally in the area of course submission and alignment we're there the the multi-division online providers often provide services in the area of cte so the word competencies was also

[03:10:47] added to the course alignment and not so not just aligned with standards but also competencies and the 90 percent uh requirement of alignment was continued and also extended to the areas of the competencies so with that the superintendent does recommend that the board of education receive for first review the proposed revisions okay are there any thank you very much mr boling are there

[03:11:15] any questions I'm not seeing any whoops president Gecker yes please um I have a quick question thanks so much for the presentation Mr. Bolings just wondered you mentioned that there's been an uptick and use of these kinds of services with elementary students and I'm just curious if you could shed some light on that from a year-over-year perspective I know you indicated that these entities typically target secondary students. I was really just curious to get some perspective

[03:11:52] on the uptick that you've noticed. Are you interested in the increase in the number of students served in the elementary setting? Number and percent would be great if you have it. Right. So as compared to last and previous years, the increases are about a magnitude of five times the amount that have been previously served. And so with one provider in particular, I know that

[03:12:20] it's moved from around 2,000 in previous years to over 10,000. Wow. I'd also like to just say it's terrific to see that the department is honing in on this and really focusing on aligning what should be happening in these spaces given the reality of the pandemic so that's a huge uptick and to hear that there's some efforts to really ensure that what's happening in those spaces

[03:12:59] really uh comports with um the kinds of learning experiences we hope children will be experiencing is so important so thank you so much for sharing that and michael just for clarity that that's 2 000 to 10 000 total across k-12 with that vendor not just elementary right uh yes i'm sorry that that is true yes uh if megan reggie are on the call they might be able to clarify specifically in elementary maybe they aren't i don't have the data in front yeah hi i'm here um i'm here

[03:13:38] mr bowling and so um i don't have the exact numbers as far as the increase in just elementary that is something that we can certainly get to you via email but I can say that we know that it has increased a lot because of the pandemic and so we're seeing a lot more interest as far as parents inquiring through DOE about opportunities for their students so we don't do know that that has

[03:14:11] increased now and again we can get you those numbers if you'd like thank you so much okay anybody else don't see anybody so thank you very much mr bowling and everybody else uh and we will accept that for first review item j first review of recommended cut scores for substitute tests for verified credit and reading and writing um president gecker members of the board and dr lane um i am on the phone mr gecker so if you all cannot hear me let me know and i'll try to get

[03:14:48] closer to it. I know that I am standing between you and your progression through the alphabet, so I will do this as quickly as possible. This is on first review. It is recommended changes to the cut scores for tests that are currently on your list of substitute tests. As a reminder, the SOA gives you all the authority to approve substitute tests that can be used for students for verified credit. As you all know, you all did adopt new English standards in 2017, and we were administering

[03:15:24] new SOL reading tests this year. Because of that, it was necessary to review the cut scores for the existing substitute test. We did convene a group of teachers to do that. For the most part, they We verified the existing cut scores.

[03:15:43] There are a couple of changes for the advanced proficient and one technical change to recognize that one of the tests has a numeric scale as well as an alpha scale. There is one change in the ACT when it's used as a substitute test for writing.

[03:16:05] ACT has added a writing test, so we did make a change to acknowledge that addition. For the most part, these are fairly routine reviews, and so, Mr. Gecker, this is on first review and I'd be happy to answer any questions.

[03:16:23] Thank you very much. Are there any questions? Mr. Gecker? Dr. Geron, haven't we learned not to mess with cut scores, Dr. Geron? I have a question. I'm not messing with it. I just wanted to be clear what I heard. So Ms. Livingrider, if I heard you correctly, and I was looking at the chart right now, it looks like three or four of the substantive changes are in the advanced, past advanced, and they raised it slightly, and that was as a recommendation of the teacher work group.

[03:16:53] Is that correct? Those are the recommendations of the teacher work group. And they were to raise it one point. That's what I see. Yes. What you see in the chart are the recommendations of the teacher work group.

[03:17:08] Very good. Thank you. Anybody else? I don't see anybody, so thank you very much. Thank you. We appreciate it. Item K, First Review of Child Abuse and Neglect Recognition and Intervention Curriculum Guidelines. Dr. Hollins.

[03:17:31] Thank you so much, President Gecker, Vice President Wilson, Board Members, and Dr. Lane. I'm here to present for your first review the Child Abuse and Neglect Recognition and Intervention Training Curriculum Guidelines. As many of you know, beginning in 2003, these guidelines require compliance with a by renewing licensure or initial licensure to complete a module that really encapsulates a very wide berth of information and given some of the legislative changes that have happened in recent years which was detailed for you within this item it's been necessary for us to update these guidelines as well as work with our partners across the state

[03:18:07] including the department of social service social services to provide a free recognition and intervention online course for educators that meets the requirements of these approved guidelines this module was last updated in 2018 and this course already meets many of the new requirements that you'll see within the proposal before you of course as a partner in the development of these guidelines the department of social services will work alongside the virginia department of education to ensure the update to the course fully comply with all new requirements once you approve so this information is before you today the state superintendent of public instruction recommends that the board receive for first read the proposed revisions and as always

[03:18:45] i'm happy to answer any questions or concerns or provide any next steps for follow-up thank you president gecker thank you uh any questions i don't see any dr holland so thank you very much for the presentation and i guess we'll see you next month for the final thank you so much don't forget about school counseling week and virginia kindness week in the interim great to see you guys well i have them on my calendar but thanks for the reminder ah item l first review of revised

[03:19:19] guidelines for policies on concussions and students hello mrs wigan hello good afternoon president gecker members of the board dr lane i am delighted to present for first review the proposed guidelines for policies on concussions and students the 2019 general assembly amended the code to require the board of education to collaborate with various stakeholders and biannually update its guidelines on policies to inform and educate coaches students and parents about the risk of concussions and provide guidance on evidence-based protocols for return to learn

[03:19:58] and return to play on behalf of the board of education several meetings were convened with clinicians neuroscientists researchers and other key stakeholders identified in the legislation the concussion review committee's recommendation included in attachments a and b add progressive research-based approaches to physical rest, returning to learning, and screen time. They emphasize early recognition, appropriate response to concussions, and monitoring ongoing or new

[03:20:33] symptoms. They support a multidisciplinary management approach with appropriate healthcare providers directing the student's recovery in collaboration with educational professionals, differentiating academic supports. They enhance phase guidance protocols for a stepwise gradual increase in physical and cognitive demands without a return of symptoms that allow students to heal while continuing their education and they also add physical therapists licensed by the Virginia Board

[03:21:06] of Physical Therapy to the Board of Education's list of appropriate licensed health care providers. the superintendent of public instruction recommends the board of education receive for first review the proposed revisions to the guidelines for policies on concussions and students thank you wonderful thank you uh are there any questions this is the benefit of presenting at the later hours of the board meeting they've they're all worn out so so president gecker i

[03:21:42] was actually thinking you know we certainly don't want staff to think that we are uninterested but some of these are just so straightforward so sorry about that all right we are very interested and uh but it is fairly straightforward so thank you for the presentation and we will see you also next month the board will take this on first review thank you okay item m first review of the advisory board on teacher education and licensure's recommend recommendation for a passing score in the praxis or for the praxis middle school science test for and excuse me for the middle education

[03:22:18] 68 science endorsement. Ms. Pitts. Yes, I'm back. Good afternoon, President Gecker, members of the board, and Dr. Lane. First, I'm pleased to introduce to you Malik McKinley, who is also on the call today. He is from the Educational Testing Service. He is a Director of Client Relations. You've not met him previously. He's not new to ETS, but he is fairly new to to Virginia as our representative from the Educational Testing Service.

[03:22:51] So thank you, Malik, for joining us today. Currently, as you know, the Board of Education requires assessments for initial licensure, Virginia communication and literacy assessment, as well as practice subject assessments.

[03:23:08] And one of those we are reviewing today, as well as the reading for Virginia educators test required for specified endorsement. The proposed recommendation from the advisory board on teacher education and licensure is to set a passing score for the Praxis Middle School Science 5442 test for the Middle Education 6-8 science endorsement.

[03:23:34] This test will be required for individuals who are seeking an initial license with an endorsement in Middle Education 6-8 science, with the exception of those individuals who apply for a license, you'll have a full credential with no deficiencies from other states who are not required by law to take those assessments. It's also used as an option. Individuals who take and pass the test may add an endorsement in middle education six through eight science so they can take this test and add the endorsement to their existing license.

[03:24:14] You received the Multi-State Standard Setting Technical Report and the Praxis Study Companion. ETS revised its assessment for the Middle School Science test and the Praxis Middle School Science 5442 will replace the Praxis 5440 test that we are currently using.

[03:24:37] A Multi-State Standard Study was designed and conducted by ETS to support the decision-making process of education agencies establishing a passing score for this test. We did participate in the multi-state standard setting panel. You received the multi-state panel's recommended passing score of 152. AFTEL is recommending a passing score of 147, which is one conditional standard error of measurement below the recommended score. This is a new test and the middle school

[03:25:17] science area is a critical shortage area of teachers in Virginia. Therefore, AVTEL is recommending one CSEM below the standard panel's recommendation and this is not unlike other recommendations from abtel that have previously been approved by the board of education the superintendent of public instruction recommends that the board of education receive for first review the recommendation of abtel to establish a cut score for the practice praxis middle school

[03:25:53] science 5442 test thank you and i'm happy to answer any questions and mr mckinley is always also with us today well welcome mr mckinley and thank you ms pitts uh are there any questions from the board no questions but just thank you mr mckinley and ms pitts for leading this and bringing forward um recommendations from our committee and uh look forward to supporting this i middle school science is an area that is a great need and i'm happy that we're working and focusing on this so

[03:26:29] thank you mr mckinley and ms pitts for your work on this thank you thank you anybody else i don't see anybody so we will accept this on first review and see you in march i guess thank you very much okay item n first review of approval of timeline for the virginia mathematics pathways pathways initiative good afternoon um thank you president gecker vice president wilson superintendent lane

[03:27:07] and distinguished members of the board of education my name is tina mazikane i'm the mathematics coordinator in the office of stem and innovation at the department of education and I'm very excited to be here today to talk to you about the Virginia Mathematics Pathways Initiative, or what we call VMPI. Last year we came to you in January at one of your work sessions and talked about VMPI, gave you a little bit of a preliminary overview of the initiative, and we did seek feedback from you at that time to further develop the proposed changes.

[03:27:40] So today I'm here to update you regarding the progress of the initiative, to describe some considerations from some of the stakeholders that we've had a chance to speak to and to seek your

approval and feedback in moving forward with actions to support implementation of the initiative and tina i'm trying to pull up your presentation i'm having trouble again um so i may need to hop off real quick and give dr lane hosting controls but we will get it up kind of asap if once i'm able to figure out where you're having problems this

[03:28:16] morning too okay well i can keep talking um and all of us have it lately uh vortex yeah and emily if you make me the host i can i can share my screen till you get back and just let me know in your back and we'll switch it back over to you yeah um and just for uh the board as well as the public um board members it is linked in your board book and for the public it is also on the website

[03:28:43] and i i'm assuming board members you can see my screen now yes thank you okay great all right i will see if i can't find a quick way to make this large okay go ahead tina okay thank you dr lane um if you could forward um i am on um the next slide i believe all right great um as you may recall the Virginia Math Pathways Initiative is a joint initiative among the Virginia Department of Education, the State Council of Higher Education for Virginia, and the Virginia

[03:29:24] Community College System. It's a multi-phase project and it focuses on ensuring that all students have equitable access to high quality math instruction and it really seeks to strengthen the articulation between K-12 and post-secondary opportunities for our students when it comes to mathematics. So on the next slide, we wanted to let you know that this initiative is grounded in the belief that every student should be empowered and engaged as a mathematical learner. We want them to experience success in math. We want them to become fully prepared to meet the quantitative

[03:29:59] demands of the future lives and careers that they're going to have. However, we know that there's a lot of stories about students who are matriculating through K-12 mathematics public education programs across the country that really don't reflect these beliefs um so dr lane i will probably click through these i don't know if they're animated or not it doesn't look like it but um i'm going to read through some of these stories because they they kind of paint a picture for us about math education in in the nation somewhere in the united states there's a recent high school graduate who excitedly starts her first semester in college while she passed advanced

[03:30:36] mathematics courses in her senior year of high school, her university informs her that she is not college ready in mathematics. Another high school student decided not to take any mathematics courses beyond those required for graduation because nothing in his experience has helped him see how mathematics is relevant to his future. Still another student wants to take additional mathematics courses but cannot because his school does not offer them. Another student is steered away from advanced mathematics courses by her counselor based on that counselor's perceptions of her race

[03:31:11] or family background. And somewhere a recent university graduate having successfully navigated the transition into and through college mathematics finds that what he learned in his mathematics courses did not prepare him with the quantitative skills that he needs for his future. And so these are stories that were told in a recent report, a national report titled The Launch Years: A New vision for the transition from high school to post-secondary mathematics. And it was published in 2020 in collaboration with the Charles A. Dana Center at the University of Texas at Austin.

[03:31:47] And these same stories really could easily occur somewhere in Virginia. So we really need to work to change these stories in order to provide opportunities for students to succeed. Dismantling inequitable structures that challenge spaces of marginality and privilege are needed. We really have to

ensure that every student is well prepared with the mathematical literacy that they require and deserve for both their future personal and professional lives. So we're pleased to report that the national landscape in mathematics education has begun to change. The National

[03:32:23] Council of Teachers of Mathematics published a book titled Catalyzing Change in High School Mathematics in 2018. This book was intended to initiate some critical conversations about high school mathematics across the country. The current sequence of Algebra 1 geometry and Algebra 2 was originally established in the late 1800s and has continued to be the model for teaching high school math. This book challenges educators to think differently about the purposes of school mathematics and it encourages us to examine our current structures that may impede equity, to analyze the current instructional practices through the lens of equity, and to carefully

[03:33:02] consider what essential math content all students should learn in high school. There were two additional books that were published in 2020. There was a Catalyzing Change in Early Childhood in Elementary School and Catalyzing Change in Middle School. And these books all promote a set of key recommendations that can be articulated across the K-12 grade levels. In addition, Virginia has been participating for the past two years in a forum with 23 other states across the country that's been organized by the Conference Board of Mathematical Sciences. CBMS is an

[03:33:38] umbrella organization of over 15 national math and statistics organizations, and our VMPI team has been able to collaborate and share strategies with other states for changing math pathways and promoting equity. In addition, there are two notable position papers that have been promoted by the National Council of Supervisors of Mathematics, and they challenge the current state of mathematics education one called closing the opportunity gap a call for detracking mathematics was published in 2020 and the other mathematics education through the lens of social

[03:34:11] justice acknowledgement actions and accountability was published in 2016. both papers emphasize the need to change mathematics education and acknowledge that social social justice must be a key priority and the access to the engagement with and the advancement of mathematics education for all of our country's youth on the next slide um we we have a quote from the national council of teachers of mathematics that it encourages stakeholders to have critical conversations um to address deficit-based beliefs yes sir i apologize emily and i just need to switch back real quick so

[03:34:50] emily's going to share her slides now and emily runs by five right tag tag emily you're it now Well, it's a good place to segue because we're very pleased today to have Dr. Trina Wilkerson with us. She is the president of the National Council of Teachers of Mathematics, and she's going to share a little bit more about what is happening at a national level and how that has helped to change and shape the Virginia Mathematics Pathways Initiative. So, Dr. Wilkerson, I'll let you take over for a few minutes.

[03:35:26] Thank you. I would like to thank you, along with Tina and Michael as well, for inviting me to speak to the Virginia Mathematics Pathways Initiative. I speak on behalf of the National Council of Teachers of Mathematics, the largest mathematics education organization dedicated to K-12 mathematics education. NCTM advocates for high quality, engaging mathematics teaching and learning for each and every student. The work of Tina and the teachers and leaders across the state is developing a system that does just that. An analysis of students leaving high school reported that nearly 60 percent were not equipped with the mathematics to enter college, and this in turn significantly

[03:36:06] impacts immediate vocational opportunities for students choosing that path. I support Virginia's leadership and commitment to create a system which addresses these challenges and creates a structure to provide and support equitable opportunities for all students in Virginia to learn rigorous mathematics. This would make Virginia a national leader in seeing K-12 mathematics education as an engine for creating opportunities for students and their future, rather than serving as a barrier denying or limiting access to large portions of our students and adversely impacting their lives and communities. NCTM's Catalyzing Change in School

[03:36:44] Mathematics offers recommendations that underpin the forward-thinking work of Virginia's Mathematics Pathways initiative and promotes higher efficacy for students in mathematics learning. The mathematics initiative has undertaken the critical conversations across teachers and leaders in the state to address these key areas, creating equitable math structures, implementing equitable mathematics instruction, and approaching mathematics not as a set of disconnected steps, but as understanding and tools with which students make sense of our world, increase their opportunities and build their identity as persons able to do and apply mathematics.

[03:37:22] COVID-19 has revealed many existing challenges and inequities in our system that are addressed through the Virginia Mathematics Pathways Initiative. This work comes at an opportune time when we need to consider ways in which more systemic structures can be put in place to ensure that the most essential content is being emphasized in K-12 mathematics education, taught to and learned by all students. It is imperative that a wide range of stakeholders are part of the needed critical conversation and plans of action that call for a systemic approach that ensures access, equity, and excellence for each and every student. This has been the approach of the

[03:38:02] Virginia Mathematics Pathways Initiative. In the development and outreach for catalyzing change, the core ideas for this work have been shared broadly with other professional organizations and business and industry partners. For example, NCTM has engaged with U.S. business leaders in finance, transportation, and NASA through its participation with the STEM Leadership Alliance to raise awareness to these challenges and opportunities and the role mathematics plays in increasing the number of highly skilled STEM workers to meet these challenges.

[03:38:33] The role and prominence of technology and STEM opportunities through Virginia call for increasing the number of students prepared for and able to apply mathematics in these ways. The thoughtful and purposeful efforts of the Virginia Mathematics Pathways Initiative reflect the gravity of the challenges and the development of systemic programs to change how mathematics is approached and create positive outcomes for students across your state.

[03:38:59] Our hope is that the Virginia Board of Education will support the implementation of this work. NCTM is here to offer support as you move forward to provide exemplary equitable education opportunities for each and every student in Virginia that will prepare them to build positive mathematical identity and agency to engage in mathematics and enable them to contribute to the future of your state and to society. You're to be commended for your leaders and your leadership in undertaking this effort. Thank you. Thank you, Dr. Wilkerson. We very much appreciate

[03:39:34] your support and thank you for waiting today as we prepare for this presentation. We know the time frame was a little bit not not quite pinned down so we appreciate you taking your day to to hang with us and and share what you had to share so thank you very much thank you for the opportunity thank you

for being with us now the virginia mathematics pathways initiative does have five main goals which can be found on your infographic it's attachment a in your board packet and those five goals are to improve equity in mathematics learning opportunities empower students to be active participants in and what we live in as a

[03:40:13] quantitative world encourage students to see themselves as knowers and doers of mathematics you'll see the mantra on our infographic is everyone is a math person instead of hearing people say i'm not a math person we'd like to hear everyone say that they are a math person we'd like to identify k-12 mathematics pathways that support future post-secondary opportunities And our final goal is to really make sure we're collaborating with multiple stakeholders to advance mathematics education. We recognize that it takes the perspective of many to make

[03:40:45] sure that our goals are certain and lead towards success. So the Virginia Math Pathways do support a curriculum that is rich and not rushed, in which mathematics instruction emphasizes depth of understanding over procedural memorization. The VMPI supports a structure for mathematics learning that drastically reduces the need for acceleration and advocates for mixed ability classrooms. Promoting shared mathematics learning experiences for students must be explored as a way

[03:41:19] to dismantle inequitable structures that may currently exist. The shift from acceleration to deeper learning will require teachers to build stronger skills in differentiating instruction so that they can meet the varied needs of learners. These changes also have the potential for furthering interdisciplinary connections across grade levels. Mathematics curriculum and instruction should account for and leverage human difference to promote rich and connected mathematics learning experiences. A common shared mathematics learning experience

[03:41:52] benefits all children. As represented in the VMPI infographic, the proposed mathematics pathways follow a progression. Foundational mathematics concepts are building grades K through 7 based on five content strands that you see shown on the slide and those permeate across those grade levels from k to 7. These foundational years establish the roots of mathematical understanding for students. Mathematical concepts are established upon which additional learning can be extended. BMPI proposes that the current mathematical structure of Algebra 1, Geometry,

[03:42:30] and algebra 2, which is sometimes referred to as the geometry sandwich, be replaced. Beginning in grade 8, students would begin a sequence of three essential mathematics concept courses that would focus on the most essential concepts that students need to learn to be mathematically literate and to be prepared for more advanced math courses in grades 11 and 12. The essential concepts would focus on content domains such as data analysis, functions and algebra, spatial reasoning which would include geometry and measurement, probability, and mathematical

[03:43:05] modeling which really would extend across all of those domains. Then in grades 11 and 12, the MPI proposes more options for students to pursue courses that might prepare them for post-secondary opportunities. The MPI proposes that the graduation requirements be changed so that students would be required to take four years of mathematics. In grades 11 and 12, students would have the option to mix and match courses from a set of semester or half-credit course options based on various areas such as data, data design, data analysis, modeling,

[03:43:40] and computing. So students could choose from the more traditional one-credit course options such as calculus, advanced placement, and dual enrollment math courses as well. These course options

would then lead to various pathways including direct entry into career, college trade school or the military the k-12 student pathways point toward many of the cte career cluster options that student might students might use as a target for selecting courses so we're super excited about the the potential for student choice as they enter that 11th and

[03:44:16] 12th grade so on the next slide we have a timeline and and it shows how this mathematics pathways work will extend across multiple years phase one of the project actually occurred last year where we kind of started the planning process of the proposed actions of the initiative we established three teams we have an essential mathematics concepts team a mathematics pathways team and a communications team this year in phase two we've we've undergone some some of the work of the planning that happened last year the essential mathematics concepts team met to review

[03:44:56] the current 2016 mathematics standards of learning and began to define a set of those mathematics essential concepts for grades 8 through 10. That team is now seeking feedback from stakeholders, some of which we've already obtained, to revise their work and to begin creating draft standards and a curriculum framework this spring. The mathematics pathways team is working to develop a two-semester data science mathematics course, along with planning for future development of math modeling and financial modeling. And the communications team has been developing

[03:45:32] a VMPI webpage which includes the infographic you have in your packet along with an informational video. The team's also been coordinating stakeholder feedback sessions and has collected and organized feedback to help inform the work of the initiative. I would like to right now publicly thank and recognize the VMPI team members and our two VDOE math staff who've worked with passion and perseverance to develop the mathematics pathways initiative over the last two years their tireless dedication continues to amaze me i'm very grateful to work with such a diverse and diverse and

[03:46:08] cohesive group of colleagues so thank you all if you're listening a vmpi phase timeline of action step has been developed its attachment b in your board packet and the timeline for the initiative occurs over several years you'll see that it does include development of instructional resources to support teachers and also professional development for educators to help in both content and pedagogy development. So seeking the feedback of stakeholder groups regarding the changes proposed in the BMPI is extremely important, as we mentioned, for the success

[03:46:48] of the initiative. We have been able to hold webinars and meetings with various stakeholder groups beginning in September 2020 through January of 2021. And as you can see from this slide, the stakeholders providing feedback included individuals who were able to provide many different perspectives. Feedback was collected informally during the webinars through discussion and also formally through a feedback survey that was shared virtually with participants, and they were able to respond. During each session, we asked the participants to share

[03:47:23] what excites them about the Virginia Mathematics Pathways initiative. And we created this wordle that highlights some of the key words that were shared by the stakeholders. And they were really excited about the opportunity for students to learn more deeply through identifying content that's most essential in learning mathematics. They conveyed enthusiasm about the proposed pathways and their potential to expand the math course options and choices for students.

[03:47:50] and they also positively reflected upon the initiative's potential for emphasizing the application of mathematics and the opportunity to further interdisciplinary connections with other disciplines across

the grade levels. The stakeholder feedback we've received thus far has also provided us a lot of insight into some important considerations as we continue.

[03:48:14] We were able to identify five major considerations that we wanted to bring to your attention. the first is shifting from acceleration to deeper learning through differentiated instruction the proposed shift to move through mathematics content faster to learning more deeply about mathematics ideas and authentic applications is going to require an explicit course of action beliefs whether they're historical cultural or social about children's mathematical abilities that might contribute to inequitable practices in math grouping and acceleration will need to

[03:48:50] be examined quite closely. A second consideration was supporting access to rigorous coursework. Some of our stakeholder feedback revealed that they had some concerns about how the changes would impact students preparing for a study in more mathematics intensive fields. The VMPI leadership team wants to make sure that they'll ensure that the math course options being proposed will provide a pathway to pre-calculus and calculus level work while also paving the way for just other just as rigorous course options such as data analysis mathematical modeling computer science

[03:49:27] and other rigorous mathematics the third consideration that was brought to our attention centers on providing equity and readiness and access being able to dismantle the inequitable structures that challenge spaces of marginality and privilege are really going to be needed to to ensure that every student is well-prepared for both that math literacy that they require and to prepare for their personal and future professional lives.

[03:49:55] So we wanna make sure that we're, have a consistent identification of who are those students that have unfinished learning, especially important in a time right now when we have a lot of concern about learning loss with children, and how would they benefit from additional support strengthen and deepen mathematical understanding. So that that idea of readiness is going to play a pivotal role in the success of this initiative. Another consideration was about teacher preparation, licensure, and teacher shortages. And our stakeholders really echoed that we need to

[03:50:32] consider changes to teacher preparation programs if we're going to make these changes, to take into account teacher shortage issues and to re-examine possibly some changes in licensure that might be required with our teachers. And the fifth consideration centered around assessment.

[03:50:51] Many of the stakeholders revealed that they had consideration about how do we determine what student assessment will look like based upon these proposed changes. The VDOE is examining options that are available as we move towards a more balanced approach to assessment. And these might require looking at scoring scenarios that might be different than what we currently use. We are currently working with our Office of Student Assessment. They are highly involved in our work and we are confident that we'll be able to move forward with these changes.

[03:51:26] The Virginia Math Pathways Initiative is focused through the lens of the profile of a Virginia graduate. The implementation of an integrated set of essential math concepts in grades 8 through 10 aligns very nicely with the profile's direction to emphasize the development of core skill sets in the early years of high school. VMPI is highly aligned with the profile in establishing multiple paths towards college and career readiness for students to follow in the later years of high school. So this concludes my presentation. The Superintendent of Public Instruction recommends

[03:52:02] the Board of Education waive first review and approve the timeline to move forward with the implementation of the Virginia Mathematics Pathways Initiative. And at this time we're happy to address any questions that you might have or we would be happy to take some feedback that you might be able to provide to us as well. Yeah, are there any questions by board members?

[03:52:23] Dr. Wilson and then Ms. Halton after that. Thank you so much for the presentation and the detail about the work that has been going on. Really appreciate it. I do have a couple of questions i mean if you if you already answered this i'm sorry i bet i missed it um i wonder about um with the changes in terms of the frame uh with the half credit courses do you anticipate that there will be new endorsements or requirements for teachers working in with those particular courses or do we believe that the current endorsement would cover the requirement well

[03:53:00] we anticipate since their 11th and 12th grade courses that that teachers that are mathematics endorsed so six through 12 mathematics endorsement that they would that would cover the courses that were that we're proposing would they need some professional learning and development most likely so as we develop those courses we will plan professional learning opportunities as those roll out so that's certainly in the in the works okay thank you then my second question actually goes to the other end of the spectrum from high school to early learners we heard earlier today

[03:53:33] a presentation from Ms. Conway on the early learner standards. And this model, this pathway starts at K. I wonder where the connection is from birth to five and then jumping into this pathway. So that, you know, of course, that consistency will be very important. Absolutely. And the work of the catalyzing change does start in early childhood. So we've had the opportunity to promote several

[03:54:09] book talks and we have one going on currently where we have teachers and specialists taking a look and reading each of those three books and then they're going to share across that spectrum. So we recognize that linking up with early childhood education is going to be vitally important to maintain that whole articulation across the grade levels. So this work will certainly have to extend uh down to k and then into our pre-k to really think about the readiness for children because we know that that's the foundational time that we've got to make sure kids are building uh that that mathematical literacy and when they have a good foundation

[03:54:48] and they have confidence in their mathematics learning then then the the the check after that makes it so much easier for kids we want to make them feel like they are they are those mathematics learners that we want them to be thank you thank you and this often uh tina uh and thank you doctor for joining us with from the with the national perspective as well great work this is so exciting i'm so impressed that this work has gone forward so vigorously in the middle of pandemic etc and that you know it's a lot and you've got a long-term uh timeline uh you're working on

[03:55:27] but it with with an ultimate goal that i think will really serve our students well um a couple of questions uh in the clarifying category uh first and one is so am i right the end of this process which you're not asking us to decide now but you're you're telling us you're going to eventually ask us to approve a requirement of four years of mathematics for all high school graduates and and and if I understand correctly currently we are not requiring we require four

[03:56:03] first advanced diploma but only three for standard diploma is that the difference um that's correct okay and then with that when you talk about um you know discouraging acceleration in favor of deeper learning as you know many students now start on their four-year math requirements in middle

school and then don't end up taking any math in their senior year of high school would this contemplate that all students advanced diploma and standard diploma would all be taking

[03:56:37] four years of math in high school unlike today that that is our goal of the initiative is is to promote four years of high school we do we do recognize that there will be students that might need credit accommodations as there exists now and those would certainly extend forward with those considerations. But I think that there's a national movement to take a look at mathematics for four years in high school. I don't know, Dr. Wilkerson, if you can reflect any further on that idea of national, you know, the national movement for four years in high school

[03:57:12] of mathematics. And I think one of the things it does is it speaks to them being college and career ready at the end of high school. Often students who do not take any mathematics their last two, three and as you pointed out, sometimes even four years, there is a disconnect, they really need to be focused on that. This also opens up opportunities for them to, for all students to engage in, for example, statistics and mathematical modeling, which are so powerful across disciplines. So we think that's another important piece that you all are looking at that's so vital. And the idea is to really go for deep understanding because the other

[03:57:48] thing that we sometimes see is students often who rush through sometimes only have a surface understanding of things. And this would allow deep understanding and be able to spend time exploring those things and allow us to challenge all of our students. So I think that's an important piece of this. Thank you, Dr. Wilkerson. So I think it's very exciting and I think absolutely in terms of college and career readiness, math all the way through high school makes total sense however the pushback is one the caveats are we've been trying to give our

[03:58:24] high schools more flexibility to help students do career exploration and and work-based learning etc etc and so there is a little bit of a tension between more dictating the fundamentals versus allowing more flexibility and so that's a decision point you're going to need to help make sure that we are clear on at some point before you get to the end of this you don't want to get to the end and go oh we've told you all along you were we were heading towards four years requirement of math in high school and now you know we don't want our stakeholders or any of us to be surprised by

[03:59:04] that so um i just i think you're doing a good job of emphasizing it but i want to help emphasize it as well because that is a real difference and including both for the the students who might now be taking the standard diploma but also for those students who are now accelerating their way through you know they're going to be requiring more math of them um um and so um so make sure we need to make sure that our our wider community is um on board um and then the second piece that goes with that is that okay in terms of teacher shortage issues and i know you're focused on that

[03:59:40] but it means you're talking about having to increase the the high school math teacher workforce by something like a third right i mean if students are mostly now taking three years of math and they're mostly going to be taking four then just my my very simple math it says you're increasing needing to increase that high school workforce by a third is that realistic right now we have these you know we are told that we have high school algebra one classes with no qualified math teacher for the entire school year in some of our more struggling jurisdictions you know

[04:00:17] it doesn't help to increase the requirements if we can't meet them and and i hear you that you're working on the school preparation school side of it but is it also a matter of resources and do we

need to help the um our state leadership understand you know it may be a matter of money and and how do we afford this greater commitment um to math education um and if we can't if we're not going to put up the money is it really realistic to set the set the standards so um not not not expecting

[04:00:55] any easy answers to any of that today but um recognizing what you're doing is incredibly important work but there's going to be some heavy lifting between here and phase eight absolutely great feedback thank you very much anybody else not i guess awesome was that a hand or was that okay i think then well thank you for the wonderful presentation always good to have people in front of us who are excited about what they're doing and i will tell you it makes a

[04:01:29] difference so um i guess the recommendation is or the request is to wave first review and to move this forward. Is that right? Yes, sir. Okay. So is there a motion to that effect? So moved, Mr. President. Thank you, Dr. Duran. Is there a second? Ms. Holt? Ms. Davis-Vaught.

[04:01:51] Ms. Holt? Just one more point of, and just to be clear, by approving the timeline, we are not approving all the elements. So this question that I'm asking about the four here, everybody understands that we may well be seeing that recommendation at the appropriate point in the timeline, but we're not being asked to make that decision yet no i think we're being asked to start down the path correct yes and any changes to graduation requirements would come through the standards of accreditation committee yep okay uh so we have a motion and a second uh dr wilson aye

[04:02:27] dr duran aye dr pexton uh ms holton aye miss davis vaught aye dr mann aye and i vote aye okay so that was six yes and uh one here she is uh dr pexton no no okay all right so thank you all very much we will uh move on to item o emily sorry about that trying to make sure i capture

[04:03:05] capture the vote correctly uh good afternoon president secretary of the board isn't he we still work on the minutes so we like to make sure we have it right all right uh good afternoon president gecker vice president wilson members of the board and dr lane i'm presenting to you today the recommended nominees to serve on the early childhood advisory committee this advisory committee to the board was established as part of chapters 860 and 861 from the 2020 acts of assembly which unify early childhood care and education programs across the commonwealth

[04:03:44] under the board and the department of education this committee will serve as the state's advisory committee for the purposes of section 642b of the improving head start for school readiness act of 2007. a superintendent's memo was released in early november to announce the call for nominations this memo was shared with school divisions early childhood membership associations smart beginning partners early care providers across the commonwealth and individuals who wish to be notified of the board's business and others in the specialty areas in this committee. At the conclusion of the

[04:04:23] nomination period, over 160 applications were received. Each application and an applicant's responses to the supplementary questions were reviewed by VDOE staff using a rubric to assess the qualifications for the categories of membership they selected in alignment with the commitment to providing equity inclusion quality family engagement and innovation scores were averaged across reviewers to create an aggregate rating the nomination of each legislatively mandated membership category was based on this rating as with other board advisory committees the early

[04:05:02] childhood advisory committee will have a three-year term if approved the committee's term will begin in February 2021 and end in June 2024 which will coincide with the other advisory committee

terms. So it is slightly longer than the typical three-year term. The full list of recommended nominees is available in your board item. The Superintendent of Public Instruction recommends that the board waive first review and approve the recommended nominees to fill vacancies on the Early Childhood

[04:05:33] advisory committee thank you emily is are there any comments or questions here one comment just want to say awesome representation look at that list you really do feel like there is going to be voice and perspective from the wide variety of actors that are providing early education so i was thrilled to see it i can't imagine the process of getting to uh 22 or so people out of 160 that's

[04:06:05] quite a cut score, but really very, very happy to see that committee launched and great work. Good. Yeah, this is more applications than we've received for any other advisory committee, and Jenna, Rebecca Ulrich, and the team did a great job kind of facilitating the process of reviewing all the applicants and making sure that we picked some really great representatives.

[04:06:36] thanks to everybody uh is there a motion then to wave first review and to approve this item so move thank you dr man is there a second second thank you dr wilson uh dr wilson aye dr duran aye dr pexton uh miss holton hi miss davis vaut hi dr man i and i vote aye okay well thank you all very much uh i'm gonna ask i know dr wilson may have to drop off

[04:07:13] um do we want to take a 10 minute break here or do the next two presentations presentations i'm push through i recommend that's fine with me i'm just offering so i don't get that all right let's go uh i do apologize for having to jump off president gecker but thank you okay that's fine good to see you uh item p uh miss walker well good afternoon members of the board and dr lane

[04:07:52] it is my pleasure to join you this afternoon to uh provide a overview of the department's recently released at navigating at equity va virginia's roadmap to equity i'm going to share my screen now so that everyone can see the slides um and i do want to also just acknowledge the contributions of jenny nurse who is the equity coordinator in our office uh and really the entire uh team at videoe who have contributed to the development of this document and the ongoing

[04:08:23] support of the work so um navigating at equity va uh really does set forth for the commonwealth our vision of what it will take to achieve equitable outcomes for students across the commonwealth specifically through the lens of our role at the state education agency and the way that we can deploy resources to the field and support their work at the local level.

[04:08:48] The line is going to go forward, there it is, okay, great. And so the way the document is structured, we certainly provide a table of contents so that there are quick links to all of the relevant resources and materials laid out in the document.

[04:09:14] And we began really with centering our work on what we call the E-Equity VA Compass, which represents the five critical competencies of Virginia's equity five C's that should undergird all of the work that we do to advance equity outcomes for students across the commonwealth.

[04:09:33] This is all research. Leah. Yes. Sorry to interrupt. I think, I don't know if others are seeing this, I see all of your slides now, not slide two. so your you may have changed i just want to make sure folks um board members and the public can see the right slide okay how about now that's great thank you okay i am so sorry everyone uh it's not a meeting till there's a technical difficulty is what i believe and that's always the case in the zoom world um so again uh we really do undergird this work with our ed equity

[04:10:07] va compass which uh provides the five critical equity competencies that we believe are essential in order to advance equity across the commonwealth for all of our students and i'll provide a more detailed view of what those five c's are but i wanted to sort of first provide how the the framework is set up we begin of course with our definition of education equity this was really really important that we articulate a clear definition of education equity for the commonwealth we started off in this work with something that was really primarily philosophical right it was

[04:10:42] really what we believe equity means for students. What we really transition to though is a definition that is informed by our data, it aligns to national best practice, and most importantly it's something that we can measure and monitor our progress towards achieving. And so we define education equity as being achieved when we eliminate the predictability of student outcomes based on race, gender, zip codes, socioeconomic status, or the languages that our students speak at home.

[04:11:12] And again, we settled on those because that's where our data tells us our biggest equity gaps exist. As I mentioned with data, the entire framework is data informed. While now, as it currently sits, this is somewhat of static data, the way it's presented within the framework, it won't stay that way. Our plan is to actually iterate on this and create a dashboard that allows us to provide in real time updates on our progress towards reaching those outcomes that we desire for all of our students across the Commonwealth. And I just don't understand why my slides are going

[04:11:51] the wrong direction. I'm sorry. What is going on here? Okay, here we go. So here we lay out sort of the biggest equity gap data indicators in the system right we're looking at achievement gaps we're looking at access to advanced academic programs we're looking at enrollment and identification in our gifted programs disproportionality and school discipline outcomes these are just snapshots of some of the data that's included within the framework but again this is an iterative process and uh we are continuing to refine the way that we analyze data

[04:12:29] collect data at the department so that we can be more data informed in the way that we support the advancement of equity across the state. It also was really important too that we provide sort of a logic model of why we settled on the strategies that we settled on. And this is what we developed which we call operationalizing systemic equity. There are lots of equity and education visuals that I think most of us are familiar with. We're typically accustomed to seeing the kids standing on boxes trying to look over the wall or through the wall and they have various abilities usually

[04:13:04] most of the kids in those depictions are brown children right um this is a little different and the reason why i like this um depiction better is because it really does focus on the system and not on the student so if we're going to dismantle systemic equity with inequity within our public education system it does require us to focus on what's happening in the system that's either producing or inhibiting uh equity for our students so in the first side we see that all of the plants are receiving the same amount of sunlight same amount of water and all of the plants are alive uh when we transition though to a systemic approach to approach to advancing equity

[04:13:43] what we then begin to see is that the system differentiates those inputs and our plants transition from survival to thriving and that's certainly what we want for our students is we want to see our students thriving in our systems of public education because we are able to adequately support their learning needs and understand that those needs might be different so within our framework we have settled on two primary strategies to advance equity outcomes for students in the commonwealth the first

is closing opportunity gaps and the second is increasing the cultural competency of virginia's educator workforce why these two things well first and foremost

[04:14:19] i want to focus in on why we selected closing opportunity gaps and some might say why aren't you focusing on achievement gaps well because achievement gap is a measure it's not an actual strategy opportunity gap really speaks more again to that system right and so if we're talking about how does the system either advance or inhibit equity we need to lean in and focus on all of the components of access to equitable opportunities and supports that our students need on the increasing the cultural competency strategy for our educator workforce, that's really informed

[04:14:51] by national research. We have seen so many studies that really do speak to the impact of culturally competent, culturally relevant pedagogy, culturally responsive practices. There's lots of different ways to sort of say the same thing. Many of you, I think, joined us for our symposium in December where we had Dr. Latson Billings come and present to the state who is really the godmother of this work and we asked her the question about sort of all of the iterative uh changes to the term that she first coined which was culturally relevant pedagogy and she said it really doesn't matter

[04:15:27] what you call it it matters that you're doing it and so what we tried to do was really articulate and lay out what we um envisioned for our culturally competent or culturally responsive educator workforce across the Commonwealth. What does that look like? What does that need?

[04:15:43] What does that mean? How do you measure it? How do you know what's happening? And that's all included in the audit tool that we provide as a companion to the framework. So here are Centering Equity Compass that focuses on those five C's: culturally responsive practice, courageous leadership, curriculum reframing, compassionate student and family engagement, and continuous reflection and we purposefully um called this the equity five c's because we wanted it to align to virginia's five c's so we want we don't want anyone to be able to think about virginia's five

[04:16:20] c's and not think about the equity five c's or vice versa because each of those things require the other to be happening in order for it to be successful so within each one of the c's in the framework we do actually provide um list out what are those competencies what does curriculum reframing require? What does compassionate engagement require? Within each page of the document you'll find too that there are resources already linked to additional supports to support to advance that work at the local level. On each one of the Cs you'll find an EdEquity VA webinar

[04:16:56] that's already hosted on our website that individuals can access as well as a national leading equity partners resources to support the work in the field. And so you see that there. I just wanted to give some examples of what that looks like. And again, the same thing for continuous reflection and culturally responsive educators. And then the next slide goes in a little deeper to courageous leadership because really this is what undergirds all of this work is courageous leaders. And what we have really tried to use the bully pulpit to say at the department is that

[04:17:34] anyone can be a courageous leader in their district or in their school community. Courageous leaders are not individuals who have named positions of authority. It doesn't have to be the equity leader or the superintendent. It can be the teacher, it can be the janitor, it can be the school counselor.

[04:17:51] All of us are called upon to be courageous leaders and to demonstrate those competencies that are associated with courageous leadership. And of course, I think it's so timely to use this quote from the

late great congressman john lewis who said you must be bold brave and courageous and find a way to get in the way and that's really what this work is all about so as a companion to each one of the competencies listed under the compass we also provided a navigating and equity va tool um equity audit tool so for each single each one of those five c's there is a companion

[04:18:26] audit that school division leaders or school building level leaders can use to evaluate where their greatest opportunities are for improvement and growth. And it was really important to us that as we designed the audit tool, that we designed it in a way that it can be used both for division level leaders, school board members, as well as a school building level leader.

[04:18:49] And we've already received so much positive feedback from the field, from school boards that have started using the equity audit tool. We've seen it being used at the building level by principals who are using it with their teams within the school and then certainly our equity leaders across the state are also using this tool.

[04:19:12] We also wanted to really sort of make a philosophical statement beyond just like how we define equity, how we use common language, and that was that equity has to be centered in all of the approaches that we so commonly use in education to advance outcomes for students, right?

[04:19:29] So we all know we have to focus on academics and SEL supports and family and student engagement. But at the core of all of that has to be our notion and our belief and understanding about what it takes to actually approach that work from an equitable lens. And so there's our heart.

[04:19:44] We center equity at the middle of it and identify our strategies there to support that. Here's a peek at the audit tool. And so even for the centering equity component, that heart, we actually give an audit tool for that as well. So like if you don't know where to start, here's where you can start with our toolkit.

[04:20:03] You can start just with centering equity. Have you articulated a vision for equity? Have you articulated expectations around equity? Who did you share those with? Who did you engage in the process? So these essential questions sort of guide and develop how we come to understand sort of where our starting place is, either at a building or district level related to equity.

[04:20:23] And then with each one of our highways, you know, we did carry a theme through this. It is a road map, so we've got lanes on these highways. And the first one on closing opportunity gaps, we've got all of these trucks on the road. These are the tactics that we're going to deploy or the inputs that we have identified that will move the lever as it relates to closing opportunity gaps.

[04:20:44] And many of these will be no surprise to you all as board members because this has really been informed by the work you all have been doing over the last couple of years on equity as well as some of the work that's been taking place at the department. also thought it was important to make sure we're using common terminology and you all talked a little bit about this in your earlier conversations about uh the teacher evaluation guidelines so within the document we also uh provided a glossary of key equity terms and this i think has been really really helpful to the field there is uh in in many spaces a perception that we don't actually

[04:21:21] know what education equity is that we don't know what cultural competence is that we haven't settled on what a definition of this means and so it was really important for the state to sort of set that foundation for the rest of the field and we did that both through aligning our definitions to the national

research and best practice as well as utilizing the work products of several other groups that have been doing this work across the state over the last several years and one of those primary groups was the african-american history education commission and their development of

[04:21:55] those four critical levels of culturally responsive practice so here we defined opportunity gap as the complex issues that contribute to achievement gaps and recognizes the historical and societal implications of the way race and class influence the kind of education and access to support a student is likely to receive you see that's a really broad definition but that a lot allows us to really be very intentional about identifying not just outcome measures but the actual inputs that will affect opportunity gaps in the state and then we wanted to also provide sort of some best

[04:22:34] practice and keys to success so through partnership with the education trust they actually allowed us to adapt one of their tools for division level consideration so they created a tool that they called Keys to Advancing Equity and Gifted in Academic Programs, and they looked at it through a state policy lens.

[04:22:53] What we did was take that same document and took the best pieces of it that are most applicable to division-level leadership, and that's where we came up with this document here. And then on increasing the cultural competency of Virginia's Educator Workforce, which is the other lane on our highway of our roadmap, you see there we have the cars that again and identify those critical inputs that are necessary to support increased cultural competency of Virginia's educator workforce.

[04:23:25] And many of these things are actually already underway. We're already talking about professional learning opportunities. Our board is considering a new component of the teacher evaluation system that will include cultural competency for the first time. We're working with our EPP programs through our new advisory committee on culturally relevant and inclusive practices.

[04:23:47] They'll be making direct recommendations around changes to EPP programs that need to take place. And then we did as well, like we did on the opportunity gaps, we've defined cultural proficiency. We've established a clear definition for the Commonwealth of Virginia, and that is that a culturally proficient education in the Commonwealth consists of environments that create opportunities for access, empowerment, and achievement by acknowledging, valuing, and advocating and empowering cultural diversity in all aspects of the educational process.

[04:24:22] And again, this is informed by national research and national best practice. And this we believe is, should be the standard bearer for the Commonwealth. Our Commission on African-American History Education had a charge to make recommendations specifically related to the professional development that was necessary across the state to support culturally responsive education.

[04:24:47] and they created what they called culturally responsive practices on four critical levels. And so we included that in our roadmap as well. And you can see there what those are. Defines similar to those profiles that we have for an education leader, for an educator.

[04:25:03] Here we have created profiles of what a culturally responsive school looks like, culturally responsive leadership, culturally responsive educators, and finally the culturally responsive pedagogy and teaching that we wanna see taking place throughout instruction.

[04:25:19] And then finally, at the end of our document, we also provided what we call the Navigating at Equity VA Strategy Notes. And within there, we have right now there's six, but this will continue to grow.

And we call these just little notes on things that school leaders can do right now, right away to advance equity for students or dismantle barriers to equity.

[04:25:43] And so this is just an example what one of those looks like on supporting equitable school discipline. And then last but not least, this is an iterative process and a collaborative process, and so we do invite the entire education stakeholder community to engage with our work by following our #EdequityVA and utilizing the resources that we continue to add to on our Virginia is for Learners EdequityVA web pages.

[04:26:11] So that concludes my presentation of the roadmap, and if you have any questions, I'll be happy to answer those. Yeah, are there any questions? Dr. Duran? Well, of course, I'm going to say thank you, Leah, for this work you've done and the framework and the clarity of the definition so that we have a statewide definition for all school divisions to really center our work on. I think to your point, you indicated having that common language actually can get people working in very different directions if we're not clear on what we're trying to do. So I think this helps bring

[04:26:49] clarity i love the visual of the the map that we're on and the highway and all the different elements that are necessary and to your point many of those are connected to the work of the board and i want to just share with my colleagues um also connected to this there's the governor's advisory committee on cultural relevant and inclusive practices that i am co-chairing with senator boisco and with the dean of vcu dr dare and there's a variety of diverse stakeholders that that have been appointed to this committee.

[04:27:22] We had our first meeting on Wednesday, January 6th and we'll be bringing back part of the legislation was to bring back recommendations to us here at the state board, particularly around social studies, social science standards of learning, guidelines around anti-bias education, professional development, what we were just talking about earlier today, evaluation and practices.

[04:27:43] So I look forward to that connecting and it's grounded and Leah is leading us through that work as well. but it's just a great connection for us. I wanted to just share with my colleagues on the board how we will have some really important part of that and in terms of the recommendations that we'll bring back.

[04:27:59] But what's wonderful is that it's grounded and connected to this broader new, I would say new for the first time as a leader in the nation really, just have a state that's leading this work in a cohesive way has commonality and intentionality.

[04:28:15] And that's why I had said my comments earlier about the teacher evaluation processes. where we can be intentional in everything we see as the board, whether it was just the math presentation we saw, anything that we are making decisions on, how do we connect our own decisions to what Leah just presented in terms of the framework and in terms of the definitions?

[04:28:36] And are we being true as a board to say that that's what we're focused on when we have all these different votes that come before us and the feedback we can give? And I know, knowing all of you, that that is a passion of ours, but now what's helpful is we have something tangible here that we can all connect to around a definition and around a focus so thank you leah and i know dr lane thank you also are leading that in terms of the commission that is copying the co-chair and look forward to that we've only had one meeting but i know we'll have more moving forward and i'm excited to bring back um all the work we're doing to all my colleagues here on the board but thank

[04:29:10] you leah thank you thank you anybody else i'll just briefly add in more chiming in yes thank you what a great piece of work and thank you for sharing it with us and please let us know how we can help you and your colleagues at the department help make this roadmap a reality for guidance for all of us involved in education pursuing education equity in Virginia as you work to share this wisdom throughout the divisions and and beyond let us know how we can be helpful this

[04:29:45] was very exciting well thank you thank you we will move on then to item o first excuse me item q status report on covet impacts on pre-k to 12 education miss coy good afternoon president gecker members of the board and dr lane uh holly coy assistant superintendent for policy equity and communications and i am joined this afternoon by michael bowling our assistant superintendent of learning and innovation and our charge at this late hour is to provide an update to

[04:30:24] you on COVID-19 impacts on education. So first I'm going to give you a bit of a historical perspective on where we are with state guidance for schools as it relates to COVID and then we're going to walk through some of the operational impacts, some of the impacts on instructional delivery as well as some preliminary data around academic outcomes and supports before we conclude with a discussion about where we go from here.

[04:30:55] So just by way of refreshing everyone's memory and helping you piece together the narrative over the last year on how we have supported our schools really practically as it relates to the pandemic. You all obviously know that Governor Northam closed all the schools back in March.

[04:31:13] And then in June, the governor released phase guidance for Virginia schools. And this was kind of a tiered and phased approach for bringing students back to school in person starting over the summer, when we were still thinking through the lens of the world through those phases, phase one, phase two, phase three, and what that meant.

[04:31:33] And that guidance had mitigation strategies based on the phases that we were in. But by October, the CDC had provided states with indicators for decision making. And so in October, the Department of Health released the interim guidance for Virginia School that then incorporated those new CDC indicators and took them into account as we tried to support local divisions as they were making decisions about if, how, and when to return back in person.

[04:32:04] And in the latest iteration, earlier this month, we released interim guidance for reopening pre-K schools to consolidate and replace all of the guidance documents we had issued previously. It incorporated a lot of the things that we had already provided to our divisions as they worked their way through these very difficult and challenging decision-making processes.

[04:32:27] However, there were a couple of notable updates with this January guidance. Here is kind of two images that I'll show you next. The first here is a five-step guide to school reopening decisions.

[04:32:47] And in the detailed guidance document, we tried with our colleagues at VDH to really lay out the series of questions and considerations for each of these steps in the process, recognizing fully that our guidance is just guidance and and was a help hopefully a helpful tool for local communities to assess the data to reflect on their strengths and resources and capacities to assess the level of community transmission around them but also how that was impacting their schools and their students understanding the broader community needs and then in this

[04:33:25] next slide at the end of this january guidance document we provided a matrix to try and help divisions really kind of hone in on okay we've we've asked all these questions what do we really do with all the information uh that we have gathered from our community from our division uh in those five steps uh and so this chart here at the end is a decision matrix again this is our recommendation for divisions um and across the top you'll see three different levels of community transmission this aligns with the levels of transmission that the cdc outlines there are

[04:34:01] specific ranges there and then along the side you'll see the level of school impact and or the ability for schools to implement mitigation and and the takeaway from this chart is that it is the combination of the two it is the community transmission levels but also the ability to implement mitigation strategies successfully which means consistently and effectively uh to to help inform uh how many learners uh or or how many groups of learners uh we would recommend be in person um we do kind of throughout this maintain the prioritization for certain types

[04:34:40] of learners for in-person instruction that has remained consistent throughout our guidance over the last year prioritizing our young learners our english learners and our students with disabilities who are disproportionately impacted by school building closures uh so that's just a quick overview of where we've been on the the guidance front with our partners at the virginia department of health i do just want to remind you and make you aware that there are a few other applicable state policies so our guidance remains guidance recommendation tools for divisions but there are

[04:35:19] some hard and fast rules so some executive orders do apply to schools such as executive order 72 which was extended just yesterday requiring the use of face coverings and restricting social gathering group sizes there are also the department of labor and industry emergency standards these were issued back in july as temporary emergency standards for employers in the commonwealth and it did capture schools as employers and actually just earlier this week the department of labor and industry having gone through a longer regulatory process

[04:35:55] issued permanent standards as it relates to health and state safety of employees during covid this includes mitigation strategies but as you might imagine it also includes reporting requirements when does an employer have to report cases to other employees and or the department of health back in our first phase of guidance oh and emily can go back real quick there was an order of the state health commissioner that applied to schools and this was an order that was issued by commissioner oliver alongside our phase guidance requiring

[04:36:33] health plans from school divisions as they reopened their doors for the first time following the school building closures back in march and then finally uh as you all know the vaccine distribution policies school staff public and private staff of any kind are included in the definition of an essential worker in phase 1b uh vaccines are a whole nother beast we won't get into the the details or the updates there today but that is a statewide policy that school staff are included in 1B. And then finally, as you all know, there are two mechanisms that give

[04:37:13] us the ability, us collectively, the ability to provide waivers and relief measures for divisions around the Commonwealth. So there is an executive order from Governor Northam declaring the state of emergency and giving executive agency heads some flexibility with that declaration of a state of emergency. But then also in the budget that was approved last spring, the superintendent of public

instruction with concurrence from the secretary does have flexibility to issue waivers around code or budget. And so we have deployed a number

[04:37:52] of those. All the waivers and relief measures issued to date are posted on the website. I won't get into all of those for the sake of time at this late hour, but do know that we keep a running list of that so that is up to date for the public at all times. We're going to shift gears to operational and academic impacts, but before we do that, are there any questions on this section before I hand it over to Michael? All right. Ms. Halton. Thank you. Holly, I'll be, I'll go straight

[04:38:28] to it since I know time is late. The VDH website still has the old pandemic metrics, school metrics up and very little reference to you know to where you've now moved and frankly the pandemic metrics on the vdh website the school metrics say that all our schools should be all closed so help us think i mean there's there's reference to the third factor of mitigation strategies but but it's it's the vague one the two charts that come up on this the two state data points both say red

[04:39:04] almost all solid red all across the state. And the second thing is vaccines. I take it vaccines come in under mitigation strategies, but I would love, shouldn't that be more explicit that, you know, where, where, where you have been able to implement, I mean, really in my humble opinion, if, if I were asked, I would say school divisions that have made the vaccine available to all staff should be able to open subject to parents options at least you know i mean there may be parents

[04:39:38] that for whatever reason need to keep particular children home but once you've got this the school's staff vaccinated isn't that a key mitigation measure that should be more explicit in the guidance those are great questions so the pandemic metrics that the cdc recommends we are continuing to use um and in our new guidance and i'll be happy to go back to the vdh website make sure that it gets um placed more prominently if it's not um in that last decision matrix chart um the emphasis is really on even if community transmission is red in that highest level if you're able to

[04:40:19] implement mitigation measures successfully and many of our schools and divisions have you can keep your doors open it is not an automatic trigger for closing your doors and so trying to more explicitly make those connections should a school an individual school or a whole division be able to you know mitigate any cases that come in expeditiously even while community transmission levels are high on the vaccine front the couple things to keep in mind yes absolutely vaccines are a key part of bringing staff back to the building and providing more and

[04:40:57] more options that was in part why this guidance came out when it did because we knew vaccines were on the horizon um we're only at the halfway point for the year and we wanted to be sure that everyone was continuing to think about um any way that that particularly those uh those learners who had been most disproportionately impacted got some in-person instruction even if it's just the last quarter recognizing how how absolutely critical that is to their academic and their their mental well-being um the one thing i will note there is that we do not perceive vaccine vaccines as a

[04:41:34] prerequisite for reopening um the other mitigation measures uh the the science is is clearer by the day when implemented with fidelity consistently they can provide safe learning environments for children and so while vaccines are are a key part to the community conversation and who is willing to come back and in what capacity they are not necessarily a prerequisite for for reopening under our guidance if i may just respond so i hear you on that point but if you you know you think of necessary and sufficient maybe the way to think of it is vaccines may not be necessary but they are

[04:42:11] sufficient and and frankly you know you've got school divisions that are open already but if you're we are now i think at the point where within the next 30 to 45 days we're going to have all our teachers fully vaccinated or have had the option to be fully vaccinated and in terms of helping new school divisions that haven't yet gotten there get there it's going to be a key metric and and maybe some of it is even just in the messaging but to counter those maps that look awful red red red maybe you put up a map of school districts that have um uh implemented

[04:42:50] their vaccination plan by 50 75 100 or something you know if we can see a green vaccination chart maybe that will be a a messaging item that would be helpful absolutely thank you i have one One additional comment, President Gecker, if it's okay?

[04:43:09] Of course, Dr. Mann. And this is on the vaccine, such an important conversation, and I don't know if there's any room to really consider recommending that as local districts, you know, focus on the potential partnerships around helping to ensure teachers are vaccinated, that we really think about the early care and education sector that I can tell you has been operating since pandemic started and it has been really difficult to see these providers struggle with the current

[04:43:47] structure that's in place to access appointments when you think about the fact that they're with children all day so where districts are making those kinds of arrangements be it with hospitals or local pharmacies or what have you, extending an opportunity for child care to be included in that, I can tell you will go a long way to having those early educators feel valued by a system that is welcoming their embrace as a part of the workforce in education.

[04:44:26] So I just wanted to put that out there because it's been really difficult to experience that disparity. Absolutely. And I was remiss in not including them on my side about the definition of 1B.

[04:44:44] Any child care staff, no matter who they're affiliated with, is absolutely considered an essential worker under 1B in the state of Virginia. We recognize fully, though, that the rollout in different communities, it looks different in different places.

[04:45:01] And so are continuing to work with other state colleagues to prioritize and ensure that we are deploying those vaccines in ways that meet the very real logistical and practical needs of the people, very people that we're trying to vaccinate.

[04:45:17] So thank you for that, Dr. Mann. Thank you. Okay. Mr. Bowling. Well, thank you very much. all as we look towards operational impacts and instructional delivery which is the first segment of the section all we'll be discussing I'd like to thank the leadership of all of the super from the superintendents down to the teacher level everyone that's been involved in all of the tough decision making that's that's gone on in navigating this difficult time it started with it starts with

[04:45:53] the superintendent of public instruction and he's done an excellent job and it's gone all the way down and a special nod to the principals and assistant principals this week especially but thank you to all. As we look at operational impacts the first thing that we look at is enrollment and overall we've had a decrease of 45,000 students across the state of Virginia as reported on September 30th. The largest drop was in the preschool and kindergarten but especially

[04:46:24] in kindergarten and if you go to the next slide it provides a visual of that drop and you can see the disparities so pre-k has dropped over 18 percent and and fifth grade has dropped five percent so you notice that a number of parents have chosen the option of not starting or delaying the start of

kindergarten this year and potentially looking at next year so as we move to the next slide it It also talks about the impact of the modality, well, the modality of instructions impact on

[04:47:01] decision making of parents in deciding whether or not to send their students to school. So those with divisions that offered only remote, we'd had larger drops in enrollment as compared to those that offered any kind of in-person instruction.

[04:47:19] As we move to the heat map of instructional modalities across the state, this slide provides some definitions as you walk through these data. We're gonna look at three specific groups.

[04:47:34] So, I mean, three specific dates starting on September 8th. And you'll note that we, this does range, the modalities range from in-person to fully remote. So fully remote in this slide is the green and the in-person is the purple.

[04:47:51] And while then in between you have different versions either hybrid or combinations of the three. And so as we move from September 8th, I'm going to ask Emily to go September 8th and December 12th and then quickly go to January and then watch and go back three and look at the change in color as we do move through those. So now we're sitting at January 26th and if we go to the next slide, it will show you where these changes have been made.

[04:48:23] So we've had a decrease on the fully remote number of divisions offering fully remote instruction, and that percentage has dropped by about 20% since September. And those have shifted into some version of in-person instruction offering in-person instruction. And so you've noticed that that some of them went to partial hybrid, meaning they're offering hybrid for some and remote for others and then also to partial in-person meaning they have some groups of kids that are four days a week or more and then others may be in a hybrid setting and then finally to

[04:49:00] in-person which is defined as either four days or more per week for all students and so you can see how things have shifted over the past couple of months as we move forward into to the periodic data report, the board requested that we gather some data from school divisions on student achievement and academics.

[04:49:24] And so we did so. We provided a very extensive survey of 96 questions. And so we do appreciate school divisions responsiveness to that survey in which we had 132 responses. And this was a requirement for responding if they were interested in consideration of a waiver in the spring for the 180 day 990 clock hour requirement.

[04:49:52] The data collection included the areas of instructional delivery, academic outcomes, division wide challenges, assessment strategies, and then supports for students. And so we'll jump right in to instructional delivery. Let's start with, let's go to the percentage parents opting for remote learning and so this is each division weighed in on their percentage of parents that opted for remote instruction when there was an option for either in-person or hybrid instruction only and um and you notice that they they ranged from

[04:50:31] really the averages were in the 20 to 40 percent range as we move to the next slide for the students now the note the the end count at the bottom so this is based on 132 divisions that responded to this question talking about for their students that do have when they do have remote instruction what percentage of that remote instruction is synchronous and so you you'll see that over 40 school divisions have half of their instructional time synchronous while in remote

[04:51:07] learning settings as we move to the next slide remote learning challenges was the question where what is your your greatest challenge and failing students and access to reliable internet were two of the largest challenges that that exist when we started looking at internet access very early on right at the beginning of the pandemic it was we estimated and we do estimate that it started out around 20 percent of students not having access and we have provided a number of funding sources

[04:51:44] that have provided a reliable internet access for many students but we still have challenges in the in this area as we move to absenteeism you'll note that over 50 per i'm sorry over 50 of our school divisions are reporting absenteeism as higher than last year now i think it's important to note that every school division gathers absenteeism data in different ways meaning they have different instructional modalities some of them are in person some of their in in hybrid settings some

[04:52:21] of them have asynchronous learning days and and so there is a so much variation in the way that we offer um instruction that there is variation in the absentee in in how we count absenteeism so at this point i'll pause really quickly on any of these uh slides that we've talked about when it comes to absenteeism learning challenges and enrollment actually michael do you know and i should have asked it before today uh you know this is division by division the charts you've got like

[04:52:58] page 21. do we know what percentage of kids that is since all divisions aren't equal in terms of population i mean we have some that basically dwarf the rest uh we are you asking for the like statewide how many parents are off opting for remote instruction well when you say well yeah i guess in a sense yes i mean because my guess is that 50 of let's say fairfax's parents is a different number than 50 of you know southwest county's uh parents that is correct and that

[04:53:38] that data point is being collected in the student record collection and so we will have hard numbers on that we do have numbers on that that we can gather and provide to you but this was division by division reporting on the percentage of their parents opting for remote instruction yeah no i get what this represents i guess when you get the data that shows how many kids are impacted or how many families are impacted i would appreciate having that we can certainly provide it in our next update absolutely thank you yeah if i may michael we yes that would be a great update to

[04:54:15] have but just anecdotally am i correct that most of our really big systems are either fully remote or uh largely remote and therefore uh that skews the the impression one might get from division stats a little bit here. Exactly. Dr. Lane, did you want to... Michael, I'll take that. Yeah.

[04:54:43] Yes, our largest divisions to date have been predominantly remote. Some of them made an attempt to go in person maybe for a month between October and November and then close back down as it got closer to the holidays. But we're hearing a lot of movement. And so the map that you're going to see references, you know, Fairfax, as an example, being predominantly remote, Chesterfield being predominantly remote. Both of those are planning to go at least in person with their elementary school students in February. So your next update, I think, will have a much larger uptick by number of students because those largest divisions will be moving modalities. But, and to Mr. Gecker's

[04:55:23] point, I'll say this somewhat anecdotally, but we're hearing in most school divisions somewhere between 10 and 30 percent of parents, even when in-person is offered, choosing remote. And we'll have more specific data the next time we get together. Thank you. Thank you. If you don't mind, I'm going to jump right back in and continue the data. Is that okay? Sure. All right. The next section will focus on

academic outcomes and supports, and we're going to start off with the PALS screening. That's the phonological awareness literacy screening test, and the next slide, or

[04:55:58] actually the next three slides, provide a lot of detailed information and background on what PALS is. And so if you'll move to the next slide, this is an assessment that's given by 99% of our school divisions, all but one. And just to note that because of challenges in instructional modality, there was an option, a remote option provided, and 55% of our kindergarten and first grade students did exercise that option, but for people that have concerns about the testing and the validity

[04:56:38] of the testing in a remote setting versus what is done in person, the state trends were similar across both remote and person administrational methods, and so there is a full paper coming out on the PALS data, but I'm going to go to the next slide and talk about the big key findings and takeaways what this chart shows are the percentage of students that are identified as at high risk for reading failure as compared from fall 19 in the light blue to fall 2020 in the

[04:57:14] in the dark blue and so you see that in both kindergarten and first grade the increases were roughly 10 percent in each of those grades and if you move on to the next slide this slide indicates that there were significant changes or increases especially in those students that were black hispanic economically disadvantaged and english learners and if you move on to the next slide we'll talk it has the data by grade level so this is this shows a comparison of each

[04:57:50] student group in kindergarten and the disparities in the increases between each group from last fall to this fall. If you move to the next slide then it has the first grade students and the percentages are looking pretty similar. The next slide talks just a little bit about kindergarten readiness, so vk rp data it has uh it provides our only statewide assessment of social emotional skills

[04:58:27] although many school divisions every school division is providing different kinds of measures and and dipsticks on social emotional learning but this slide provides some more detailed information about concerns that were raised by the assessment that teachers have about the well-being of students with their social and emotional health and well-being. As we move on, the academic achievement in the first marking period, the number of so in this this slide summarizes the number of the percentage of students that are at or above expected levels

[04:59:05] in reading and mathematics and you can see the difference between pre-k and two and three and five when it comes to reading and mathematics. So a number of school divisions are reporting that their students are are at or above expected levels in reading and mathematics. However, when we're talking about 68 percent is is determining that 50 percent of their students are at or above, that also shows that there has been some significant loss. As we move forward, the comparison of failure percentages, this slide talks about middle school, the next slide talks

[04:59:43] about high school and it asked uh school divisions to compare their failure rates or i'm sorry the number of students percentage of students failing two or more classes at the end of the first marking period compared to last year and so this shows um that that vast majority of school divisions are seeing a high percentage of students that are failing two or more classes compared to last year. The next slide is similar and moves to high school. Emily, if you can move to the next

[05:00:17] one. Okay, great. As we move to the next one, I'm going to let Dr. Lane take this one from here. Thank you. Emily, you can move forward to the next slide. Thank you.

[05:00:38] First, I want to thank Holly and Michael for taking all of this data from the periodic report survey and analyzing it. And what we started to learn quickly is that in the absence of a fall diagnostic assessment that's given in every school division statewide like PALS, we didn't have a really great sense of, even with the data they're reporting up to us, how we could compare what's going on across divisions. And so I made a decision to reach out to a few of the largest vendors in the space that give these type of interim and benchmark assessments, especially a fall assessment and ask about what their data looked like and so we're going to give you

[05:01:15] two examples of that but before I show you this data I want to provide a couple caveats that these are not even though they're they look in a lot of ways like our state assessment these are not our state assessment they are given virtually and so we cannot make any guarantees around what type of supports a student may have received at home and so you know I can tell you I've gone and read the classes and when I ask the kids a question sometimes the parents will chime in on virtual classes and so uh you know so i can't say for certain that i think we have to caveat that potentially students could could receive support

[05:01:53] on these at home even though that's not intended uh the other thing that i would say is i'm going to show you the nwa map assessment this is taken by around 20 to 30 000 students per grade level in virginia uh and uh we have about a hundred thousand students per grade level in virginia but 20 to 30 000 is a pretty large generalizable population and so this represents about 57 districts it includes large districts it includes small districts it includes rural includes city and so uh we feel like this is decent data and probably better data than we even received in

[05:02:29] the periodic report to help you get a sense of of how things are going but we are not providing you disaggregated data by student group so i we're not making any predictions like pals was able to do at this time of whether students in poverty were more impacted or students of certain races or genders or anything like that and so with all of those caveats and so be very careful about generalizing this data too much uh what you'll see here is the the RIT score is kind of like you know our SOL score has a scale that goes up to 600 the RIT score is a vertical scale that the NWA

[05:03:04] map uses this is a computer adaptive assessment so we compared the fall 19 pre-COVID results from students to the fall 20 and again thank you to the vendor nwa map for providing this to us and you can see that actually year over year in third grade reading results are actually up uh uh in this assessment with the caveats that i provided plus many others fourth grade about the same fifth grade uh you know uh similarly slightly up sixth grade slightly up seventh grade down one one hundredth of a point eighth grade uh slightly up and so then i you shift over and look at math

[05:03:42] and you can see you know third grade is slightly up but then you see declines at fourth fifth sixth seventh and then back up again in eighth and so what i what i would say to you is and with a lot of careful uh caveats some initial findings of one of the only statewide assessments that we have or you know at least the 57 divisions but with a pretty large population is that in the older grades whereas we know that pals show that our younger students are facing some learning loss we might have been able to come close to maintaining levels in reading but we are

[05:04:22] seeing some learning loss in math but maybe not as much as we may have predicted now i want to be a lot very careful about generalizing too much we've got a lot more mid-year will be a better assessment if you think about the fall assessment this is you know essentially six months from the closure of schools we've had a lot go virtual i think we'll know more with the mid-year assessments and so you

know being a little bit careful there there's a great assessment of a statewide opportunity moving forward to the next slide uh we have some percent pass rates here so map does

[05:04:59] a linking study where they link their their vertical scale to our sol scale and then do projected proficiency of students uh i should mention that uh the the reading linking study was intended to expire at my request they used the old linking study to give you a sense so that's another caveat i would put on this uh so it's not based on your new sol that's going to be given at the end of this year as an example uh with the new cut scores that you set but what you can see is that uh when you translate that same writ score into percent proficiency you see a similar trend

[05:05:35] to what i shared on the last slide that at least the students in the school divisions that take the nwa map have maintained some proficiency in reading and in some grade levels potentially increased and that uh you're seeing some slight declines in learning or declines in learning loss in math but maybe not as large as as we may have predicted so we reached out to other vendors in this space uh power school is committed to provide us data by the time we get together in march which which is another large vendor, but STAR Reading, what did produce a similar report, so that's on the next slide.

[05:06:11] And you'll see that STAR Reading's results somewhat mirror what we heard from MAP, that maybe reading results are down 2% in Virginia, maybe 1% nationwide. I think that's probably strongly within a margin of error there, but that maybe not only Virginia, but as a nation, we're maintaining reading results at relatively close to where we are.

[05:06:35] I think star reading, just so you know, is in about 30 districts and maybe a few of the smaller districts weighted over overly here. And so we're going to reach out to IREADY. We're going to reach out to others. But I wanted to explain this to you in a little bit more depth, but with a lot of caveats before we generalize too much here.

[05:06:55] But potentially, if our SOLs back these results up at the end of the year, some reason for optimism. And I think this is a huge credit to our teachers. know the virtual learning in the spring of last year is vastly different from what we know now and then of course we've gotten a lot of students back and I think our teachers have done a phenomenal job so Michael I'll turn it back to you well thank you Dr. Lane and just clarify also on the NWEA map data that that was representative of 57 school divisions data that was being reported which is a good cross-section of Virginia including small medium and large school divisions and looking at professional development one of the

[05:07:34] questions that we ask school divisions is the types of professional development that they have offered and provided to their teachers. I got to tell you, the teachers, as Dr. Lane said, are the real rock stars here, and they have pivoted and learned so much so quickly, and our hats are certainly off to them because they, for many of these individuals, they never taught or had an experience on virtual learning and so now they have certainly and so school divisions provided a great deal of professional development in the vast majority in these areas including all many

[05:08:12] aspects of virtual instruction high quality instructional resources how to get the right types of teaching materials for virtual learning settings supporting social emotional health and getting communication and feedback expectations for teachers to students and students back to teachers and teachers to parents etc and then also structuring the remote learning environment as well as helping parents and guardians understand how to use the learning management system when maybe they never had to use it before and also the student information system and those are heavy

[05:08:46] heavy lifts that's not adequately weighted in one slide in this presentation it's a tremendous effort on the behalf of all school divisions and teachers in the state of Virginia. As we move forward I will quickly run through the last few slides which summarize the administered diagnostic assessments as well as some other supports that were provided and so these are counts of divisions that offer different types of assessments. You see that a great number offered PALS and also VKRP but I'd also like to note that over 70 divisions are used the just-in-time mathematics quick checks

[05:09:25] in which the assessment division in collaboration with the instruction division staff did an incredible job of creating in response to the pandemic as well as a number of school divisions using power school and performance matters as well as locally developed assessments and many many others if we move on you'll see that here are a number of social emotional supports that have been provided by a number of school divisions and so you see that they've been really put a strong emphasis on social emotional health and well-being of students

[05:10:02] Emily if you'll move to the next slide and with students with disabilities we find the same thing is that they've provided a number of supports for for students with disabilities and as we move on you'll see is some similar trends with English learners as well. And so as the this presentation is posted online, and so you can certainly dig into the details of that. The final slide represented represents and the frequency of different supports provided to economically

[05:10:38] disadvantaged students throughout the Commonwealth. So with that, I'm going to wrap up. I'm not going hold for questions real quick I'm going to get to the last couple of slides and as we look ahead it just this slide kind of encapsulates everything that we've done and are going to be providing in the future as we look to continue to support all the different modalities of instruction and also through significant infusion of federal funding that will be coming and Dr. Lane I'm sure

[05:11:12] that you would like to add in on this as well but we will be asking for additional periodic data from school divisions and we'll get some additional information from other assessments both SOL and also VKRP and PALS assessments in the in the spring. So with that Dr. Lane I'll turn it over to you and then we'll we could field some questions if necessary. Yeah and the the only thing I'll add because certainly we'll provide all of this data to the board and and uh and are certainly excited about the infusion of federal money that came with CARES and GEAR 2 is that that second bullet

[05:11:48] where it talks about may include a work group with stakeholders. We are launching a remediation and recovery work group and Mr. Fairheart and his team are doing that. Linda Rivia who you've probably heard from a couple times who was our interim school quality person is going to lead that on our half. They're putting together the list of stakeholders and so certainly solicit board feedback for that if you have anyone that you think would be great uh let us know we're going to narrow that list and get that work going in the next week and you know we released the triple r document they did a great job of preparing our school divisions for opening the school year i don't know if we'll call this double r but remediation and recovery will certainly be the

[05:12:26] focus of of of the guidance we give heading into to next school year so that that work is coming and then i think last slide is questions is that right questions mr gecker any questions uh ms halton just briefly uh brilliant to use the map and other uh private assessment uh tools um as the even with all those caveats uh but i was really really smart of you all to reach out and figure out what we can learn from them one thing i'm sure you are doing but just thought i would

[05:13:04] add i hope you're asking them about their participation rates compared last year to this year because the missing students may be skewed towards a more struggling demographic and may help inform your recovery and remediation work. But what a great thing to do to reach out to the companies and get all that incredibly useful information. Thank you.

[05:13:33] And Ms. Holden, I'll just respond to that. We do have the populations year over year. They're actually pretty stable but the caveat i'll put there is a lot of school divisions probably bought assessments that did not previously because of the need to assess diagnostics so i would not assume even if you see 22001 grade level 22 000 the following year that that means that there isn't some opt-out or something like that going on so i will have to better understand how many new divisions they had to understand that uh we put after we got the data we we asked this of them literally less than a week ago and so just a huge thank you to them to putting that together so

[05:14:10] quickly we'll go into much more disaggregation in the future and they actually got excited by this and they're going to release some national reports on this i think in the next month uh uh so i i think that's good incredibly helpful to mine that mind the information you have and it'll help guide the remediation efforts going forward anybody else yeah thank you very much for the in-depth report I think you know when the board asked for the survey to be done this is exactly what we were

[05:14:42] hoping would come from it although not although about the work in this report I think as has been noted more information will be usable when it's disaggregated a little bit so that we can really have an understanding of you know who the winners are who the losers are and you know how we can addressing each group individually so but yeah on behalf of the board i will tell you how much we appreciate the work that's gone into this it's uh yeah you know it's a lot of stuff to do and it's uh

[05:15:18] you know i think just critically important to charting the future you know it may it may be we start off where we were but it also may be we've got to focus specifically on starting a little bit before where we were for some of the groups so thank you all right that finishes item q and items are through z are written reports however there are staff people associated with them if there are any specific questions on any of those reports and now we're down to discussion of current

[05:15:55] issues. Are there any current issues left to discuss? I'll say this, you know, as we move off of the sort of first phase of comprehensive plan work into, you know, the next phase, you know, I think it would be helpful if we begin to outline what our view of teacher effectiveness is and how we're going to get there, what measures we need, what evaluations we need,

[05:16:30] what linkage to PD we need so that we can lay out in a fairly succinct format where all the pieces that we're seeing come before us, you know, fit and begin to integrate them into a useful whole. I will, I hope with James' help, begin to work on, you know, something, you know, just sort of quick notes about where the board ought to be thinking about heading with the next, you know, significant focus you know Keisha's committee as we heard yesterday I used to say they'd be done in

[05:17:06] the spring what I heard yesterday was there might be some slippage there and it'll be done in the fall I expect the work of that committee and those of you on it to be you know exemplary and I expect the board not to have much issue with the recommendations that get made from that committee but the next phase of this really is focused on teachers and building leadership I will say and i've mentioned this to james before i think i've mentioned it to james before uh you know a lot of the literature focuses on teacher effectiveness as directly relating to

[05:17:42] student outcomes which is cited in our comprehensive plan uh there's also as noted a significant body of work toward building leadership uh training and how important that is and i think as we talk about these issues uh as we move forward we ought to not just focus on teachers but also begin to broaden our focus in the way we talk about this in terms of how can we train building leadership better to assist teachers in doing their job and so that's it for comments from the chair I appreciate greatly sort of the hardest working board in the commonwealth we certainly

[05:18:20] earned the money we're paid today and for the public that's listening and misunderstands that comment we don't get paid it's a you know it's a labor of love for the board members so any other comments or you know questions from board members mr gecker please very briefly if i can just acknowledge we uh do appreciate all the hard work that jlark has done and the fact that we're not reviewing those reports now does not mean we're not paying attention to them i uh i fully anticipate

[05:18:57] that the superintendent's going to bring them back to us for a fuller look we're just we're just out of time and energy today but they're really important there were also i want to make sure the public knows we do read your public comments and while we haven't touched on everything that came in in the public comments today we do expect as a regular matter and we'll follow up with the department to make sure the department is following up there were a number of important suggestions including one from the vea that we all recognize uh black lives matters in schools

[05:19:32] week at the beginning of black history month february one to five and obviously we're we're out of time to pass an actual resolution on that but i draw everybody's attention to that and uh also to uh other suggestions um in the um in the comments okay thank you anybody else if not uh thanks again everybody uh staff as well as uh you know department leadership and the board for your participation today very you know engaging meeting so we'll see y'all in march although

[05:20:08] i expect i'll see most of you before that in some fashion or another uh be safe